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PICNIC TURNS INTO TRAGEDY

Eight students drown off Maha's Diveagar beach

Students reportedly misjudged sea depth and strong currents

MPOST BUREAU
Mumbai, October 1

Eight 16-year-old students from a private coaching in Pune district drowned at Diveagar beach in Maharashtra's Raigad district on Thursday after being swept away by strong sea currents, turning a picnic involving 48 students and teachers into a tragedy. Police said all eight bodies were recovered after the students entered the sea and were unable to judge the depth and force of the water. The victims were part of a group from Winners Academy in Alandi, which had taken 25 boys, 17 girls and six teachers to the popular coastal destination, about 170 km from Pune. The students were from Classes XI and XII.

According to police, the group was visiting the beach under the jurisdiction of Dighi coastal police station when eight students went into the water to swim. They were swept away by the current after misjudging the conditions. Local residents, police and rescue personnel began searching the area soon after the incident was reported.

Bhau Maruti Salunkhe, owner of Bhau Maruti Salunkhe Mahakali Water Sports in Diveagar, and his team joined the rescue effort. The team searched the sea and recovered the bodies of all eight students. Assistant Police Inspector Santosh Awati reached the spot with police personnel, while local villagers assisted in the operation. The bodies were taken to the Primary Health Centre at Borli Panchatan for post-mortem examinations and other legal procedures.



People gather at Diveagar beach on Thursday PTI

KEY POINTS

- All eight bodies recovered after rescue operation
- Students were part of 48-member picnic group
- Group included 25 boys, 17 girls and six teachers
- Local water sports team helped recover bodies
- Police, villagers joined rescue and recovery efforts



The deceased were identified as Yash Kiran Wankhede, Soham Tukaram Bhandwalkar, Tanmay Dattatray Vahile, Kaustubh Sandeep Daund, Kaivalya Satish Wasankar, Rajveer Yuvraj Vahile, Pranav Ramdas Bansod and Sumit Bharat Ahire. All were 16 years old.

The deaths prompted concern over safety arrangements at the beach. Shiv Sena MLA Mahendra Dalvi, who represents Alibag in Raigad district, described the incident as "heartbreaking" and questioned whether adequate precautions were in place. He said young students may not be able to assess risks linked to tides, currents and water depth. CONTINUED ON P4

BATTLE OVER VOTER ROLLS

Opposition, CJP gear up for fresh showdown with EC

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi/Mumbai, October 1

The Opposition INDIA bloc and the youth-led Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) are set to launch separate protests against the Election Commission from October 2, with the bloc planning district-level 'Save Democracy' marches and a march by its MPs to the poll panel on October 6, while the CJP has announced a nationwide agitation demanding Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar's resignation. The protests come amid opposition parties' objections to the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls and allegations of irregularities in the functioning and decision-making of the Election Commission of India (ECI).

The Congress on Thursday said voices against what it described as the "capture" of the electoral system were growing louder and asserted that citizens would not tolerate "vote chori" in any form.

Congress general secretary in-charge communications Jairam Ramesh said the INDIA bloc was committed to protecting the Constitution and democracy. Citing former Chief Election Commissioner O P Rawat, he alleged that the SIR exercise had resulted in nearly 14 crore eligible voters being disenfranchised. CONTINUED ON P4



HIGHLIGHTS

- INDIA bloc to begin 'Save Democracy' marches from October 2
- Opposition MPs to march to Election Commission on October 6
- CJP plans protests across cities, starting with Mumbai on October 2

Who at EC ordered TCS to make 'illegal' change in Form 6, asks Rahul

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 1

Congress leader Rahul Gandhi on Thursday questioned the Election Commission over changes made to the online Form 6 used for fresh voter registration, asking who ordered Tata Consultancy Services (TCS) to implement the changes and who approved them at the company.

Gandhi alleged that the changes were made illegally, referring to objections recorded by Election Commission officials. He also asked whether TCS had been pressured to carry out the modifications.

"The online Form 6 was changed illegally, as the EC's own Commissioners have recorded. Who at the ECI ordered Tata Consultancy Services to make that change?" Gandhi said in a post on X.

Congress general secretary in-charge communications Jairam Ramesh, responding to the post, alleged that the changes were CONTINUED ON P4

Delhi sees most polluted start to Oct in four years

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 1

Delhi began October with its highest pollution level for the date in four years, with the city's air quality falling in the moderate category and the AQI reaching 166 on Thursday.

According to the Centre for Research on Energy and Clean Air, the last time Delhi recorded a higher AQI on October 1 was in 2022, when the index was 186. CPCB data showed that 37 of the city's 44 monitoring stations reported moderate air quality, while five were in the poor and two in the satisfactory category.

The Air Quality Early Warning System has forecast moderate air quality from October 2 to 4, with CONTINUED ON P4

NCERT Class 9 textbook introduces income tax, teaches personal finance

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 1

The National Council of Educational Research and Training (NCERT) has introduced personal income tax in the Class 9 curriculum, linking the topic to the civic responsibility of paying taxes honestly and on time.

The new textbook, Understanding Society India and Beyond - Part 2, was released on Tuesday, six months after the start of the new academic session. Its first part was released in June.

NCERT Director Dinesh Prasad Saklani said the book allows Class 9 students to learn how income tax is calculated under the slab system of the new tax regime. The textbook describes paying taxes "honestly and on time" as an "important responsibility of CONTINUED ON P4

Briefs

GST mop-up grows 15% to over ₹2.03 lakh cr in Sept

NEW DELHI: India's gross Goods and Services Tax (GST) collections rose 14.7 per cent year on year to more than Rs 2.03 lakh crore in September, supported by domestic consumption and higher revenue from imports, government data showed.

GST revenue from domestic transactions increased 10.1 per cent to around Rs 1.38 lakh crore, while collections from imports climbed 26 per cent to Rs 65,525 crore. CONTINUED ON P4

ATF prices hiked by ₹16, commercial LPG by ₹62.59

NEW DELHI: Aviation turbine fuel (ATF) prices rose by Rs 16 per litre from Thursday, while commercial LPG became costlier by Rs 62.59 per 19-kg cylinder as state-owned oil companies adjusted rates in line with international benchmarks.

ATF for domestic airlines now costs Rs 137 per litre, up from Rs 121. The increase follows a Rs 6.28 per litre, or 5.46 per cent, rise in September and a Rs 5 increase in August. CONTINUED ON P4

MACHCHHAR HAILED AS HERO

MEA says Smit recovering in Abu Dhabi as UAE opens investigation

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, October 1

Indian pilot Captain Smit Machchhar, who was seriously injured while fighting off his co-pilot during an alleged attempt to bring down a flydubai flight, was shifted to Abu Dhabi for further treatment on Thursday, as India said it was closely monitoring his recovery. Machchhar's actions aboard the Dubai-Tel Aviv flight, which was carrying 174 people, have made him a national hero, with political leaders, former sportspersons and people across the country praising his courage.



KEY POINTS

- Machchhar was seriously injured in cockpit
- Flight made emergency landing in Saudi Arabia
- Probe to examine possible planning, terrorist links
- Indian envoy meets Smit in hospital

At the same time, the UAE has opened an investigation into the incident to establish what happened inside the cockpit and whether the attack involved prior planning or any terrorist motive.

The Boeing 737 was flying from Dubai to Tel Aviv with 174 people on board, including 27 children, when it sent out emergency signals and made a sharp descent of more than 17,000 feet. It then diverted to Prince Sultan Bin Abdel Aziz Airport in Tabuk, in northwest Saudi Arabia, and landed safely. Machchhar was stabbed and seriously injured in the cockpit. Videos of the confrontation, including images of CONTINUED ON P4

FORGOTTEN SHORE



A man casts a net into the Yamuna river against the backdrop of the Taj Mahal at dusk, in Agra, Uttar Pradesh, Thursday PTI

ICICI veteran Anup Bagchi to head HDFC Bank

MPOST BUREAU
Mumbai, October 1

Anup Bagchi will become the next managing director and chief executive officer of HDFC Bank after the Reserve Bank of India approved his appointment on Thursday. He will succeed Sashidhar Jagdishan and take charge from October 27 for a three-year term, the bank said in a stock exchange filing.



Bagchi, 56, has spent more than three decades with the ICICI group, joining ICICI Bank and its subsidiaries in 1992. He has been managing director and CEO of ICICI Prudential Life Insurance since 2023 and earlier served as an executive director at ICICI Bank for six years. He also handled retail and wholesale banking during his career. He is an IIT Kanpur and IIM Bangalore alumnus.

His immediate priorities are expected to include improving core income at a time when net interest margins remain under pressure and addressing concerns over product mis-selling.

HDFC Bank has faced increased scrutiny over governance this year. CONTINUED ON P4

2027 MEN'S ODI WORLD CUP

India to open WC campaign against Aussies on Oct 7, play Pak on Oct 10

MPOST BUREAU
Dubai, October 1

India's road to the 2027 ODI World Cup will begin with a heavyweight clash against defending champions Australia in Cape Town on October 7, followed just three days later by the tournament's biggest rivalry as Shubman Gill's side takes on Pakistan in Johannesburg on October 10.

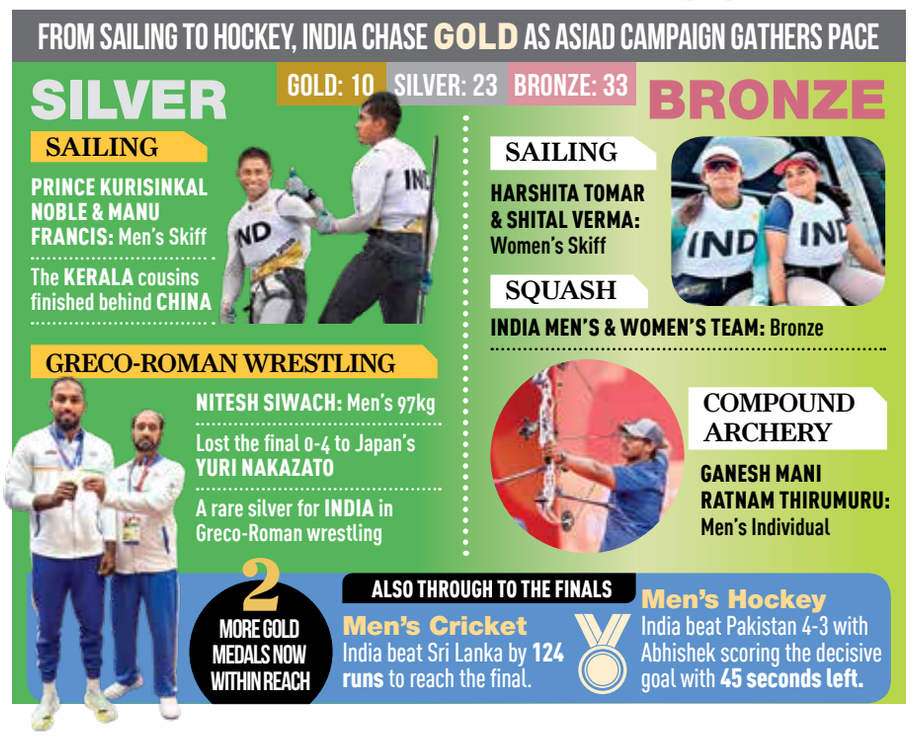
The International Cricket Council on Thursday unveiled a schedule that gives India a high-voltage start to their campaign, with the finalists from the previous edition facing two of the world's leading teams in their opening three days of action.

India and Australia will meet at Newlands before India head to the Wanderers for their clash with Pakistan. The group campaign will then take Gill's team to Centurion for a match against Afghanistan on October 14, Bloemfontein for a game against one of the qualifiers on October 17 and Victoria Falls for their final group fixture against co-hosts CONTINUED ON P4



INDIA'S WORLD CUP FIXTURES

- Oct 7: India vs Australia, Cape Town
- Oct 10: India vs Pakistan, Johannesburg
- Oct 14: India vs Afghanistan, Tshwane
- Oct 17: India vs Qualifier, Bloemfontein
- Oct 24: India vs Zimbabwe, Victoria Falls
- Nov 17/18: Semi-final, venue depends on qualification and standings
- Nov 21: Final, Johannesburg, if qualified



AAP SENIOR LEADERS, IYC MEMBERS EXPECTED TO ATTEND

Cops deny permission for Oct 2 protest against CEC

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 1

Delhi Police on Thursday denied permission for a proposed protest at Jantar Mantar on Gandhi Jayanti against Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar and beefed up security in and around New Delhi, with Central Armed Police Forces personnel deployed in anticipation of a gathering, officials said.

Police sources estimated that around 3,000 to 4,000 people could turn up for the protest, prompting heightened security measures across the area.

The protest, called by the All India Students' Association (AISA), Rajya Sabha MP Manoj Jha and Supreme Court lawyer Prashant Bhushan, seeks impeachment of CEC Kumar over allegations of irregularities in electoral rolls and the conduct of elections. AAP senior leaders and workers, members of Indian Youth Congress (IYC) and others are expected to attend the protest, sources said, adding that the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) is not expected to join the protest on Friday.

Security has been intensified at Jantar Mantar and key points in New Delhi district, with CAPF personnel deployed alongside Delhi Police teams.



> ON WEDNESDAY, AISA NATIONAL PRESIDENT NEHA BORA, BHUSHAN AND JHA HAD ADDRESSED A PRESS CONFERENCE ANNOUNCING THE PROTEST AND REITERATED THEIR DEMAND FOR GYANESH KUMAR'S RESIGNATION

CLOSER LOOK

- Security has been intensified at Jantar Mantar and key points in New Delhi district, with CAPF personnel deployed alongside Delhi Police teams
- Barricades have been put in place and additional personnel positioned at entry and exit points and other sensitive locations to regulate movement

Barricades have been put in place and additional personnel positioned at entry and exit points and other sensitive locations to regulate movement and prevent unauthorised gathering, police sources said.

The Delhi Police decision comes a day after social activists and student leaders announced plans to hold a gathering at Jantar Mantar at 11 am on October 2.

The organisers have raised concerns over the Election Commission's handling of electoral rolls and the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) exercise and alleged that it raised questions over the protection of citizens' voting rights.

Former Delhi deputy chief minister Manish Sisodia also issued a call on X urging people to join the gathering. "Come to Jantar Mantar on October 2nd to demand Gyanesh Kumar's resignation. Otherwise, the right to vote is being snatched away today, tomorrow all other rights will also be taken away," he said in the post.

On Wednesday, AISA national president Neha Bora, Bhushan and Jha had addressed a press conference announcing the protest and reiterated their demand for Kumar's resignation.

Bora, who had earlier participated in an agitation at Jantar Mantar led by the CJP over the NEET paper leak issue, said the organisers had informed Parliament Street police station about the proposed gathering, including details of the expected turnout, timing and those responsible for organising the event.

The proposed protest comes amid demonstrations by opposition parties, student groups and civil society activists in Delhi over functioning of the poll panel and the SIR exercise.

The CJP has also announced a protest in Mumbai on October 2 over the issue. After being denied permission, the party called for a "Jail Bharo Andolan".

13-yr-old 'gang-raped' in front of male friend

Six youths followed them into a dilapidated building; 3 nabbed

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Faridabad, October 1

A 13-year-old girl was allegedly gang-raped in front of her friend by a group of youths inside a dilapidated building here, with police arresting three persons in this connection, officials said on Thursday.

The girl and her 16-year-old male friend had possibly ventured inside the building -- located in Greater Faridabad area -- when the accused approached them, and threatened the duo before gang-raping the girl. An FIR in this connection was registered at BPTP police station on September 29.

According to the complaint filed by the girl's parents, the incident took place on August 24, when the 13-year-old girl went to meet a 16-year-old male friend after tuition classes. In the meantime, six youths allegedly followed them to the dilapidated building and sexually assaulted her after threatening the two minors.

A senior police officer said both children kept the incident hidden from their parents for a month.

When the girl began to show signs of severe mental distress, her mother spoke to her and the girl confided in her about the incident. After this the family approached police.



> IT IS ALSO ALLEGED MALE FRIEND WAS SODOMISED BY THE ACCUSED BUT POLICE HAVE DENIED THIS

It is also alleged that the male friend was sodomised by the accused but police have denied this.

"Based on the complaint, an FIR under sections of rape was registered on September 29, however, the allegation of gang rape has not been confirmed yet. "We have arrested three suspects in connection with the case, and are questioning them," a Faridabad Police spokesperson said.

Central Delhi: Minor raped, blackmailed with videos of act; man held

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 1

A man was arrested in connection with the alleged rape and blackmail of a minor girl in central Delhi's South Avenue area, an official said on Thursday.

The accused, aged around 30 years, had allegedly sexually assaulted the girl when she was a minor in April 2025, police said.

They said the woman, who is now an adult, has alleged that the accused had sent videos of the act to the man with whom her marriage was fixed, following which the engagement broke.

The accused allegedly continued to blackmail and threaten the girl using videos and photographs, according to the FIR.

A senior police officer said the sexual assault had taken place when the woman was a minor and, accordingly, provisions of the Protection of Children from Sexual Offences (POCSO) Act have been invoked.

According to the FIR, the girl lived with her parents in South Avenue area, where the accused was her neighbour.

She alleged that the accused raped her on the first floor of her house in April last year and recorded the incident. He then allegedly used the recording to threaten and blackmail her and coerce her into repeated sexual acts, police said. The woman further alleged that after she returned to her village, the accused continued contacting her and threatened to circulate the videos and photographs.



> THE WOMAN, WHO IS NOW AN ADULT, HAS ALLEGED ACCUSED HAD SENT VIDEOS OF THE ACT TO THE MAN WITH WHOM HER MARRIAGE WAS FIXED...

Police said the woman's medical examination has been conducted at Lady Hardinge Medical College hospital.

An FIR was registered under provisions of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita and the POCSO Act in September, and the accused was arrested.

Briefs

20-yr-old held for stabbing acquaintance

NEW DELHI: A 20-year-old sanitation worker was arrested for allegedly stabbing his 24-year-old acquaintance to death following an argument in northwest Delhi's Budh Vihar, police said. Aryan Balmiki, a resident of Budh Vihar Phase-II, was apprehended within six hours of the September 30 incident.

The victim, Hanif, a resident of Rithala village, was brought to BSA Hospital with a stab wound but succumbed to his injuries. Police said the knife allegedly used in the crime was recovered.

3 in cop net for Rs 7.86L cyber fraud

NEW DELHI: Delhi Police's Cyber Cell arrested three men for allegedly cheating a man of Rs 7.86 lakh through a Telegram-based online task and cryptocurrency investment scheme, officials said. The accused — Karan Biswas, Mohit Sarkar alias Monu and Vinay Mandal — are residents of Udham Singh Nagar, Uttarakhand.

Police said the victim transferred Rs 4.66 lakh and Rs 3.20 lakh in two instalments after being promised substantial returns. The accused allegedly used mule bank accounts to route the fraud proceeds. Two phones, a passbook and digital evidence recovered.

Rakesh Kumar Singh gets one-year extension as YEIDA and NIAL CEO

DIPIKA KIROLA
Greater Noida, October 1

The Uttar Pradesh government has granted a one-year extension to Yamuna Expressway Industrial Development Authority (YEIDA) CEO Rakesh Kumar Singh, allowing him to continue as the chief executive of both YEIDA and Noida International Airport Ltd (NIAL) till September 30, 2027.

The Industrial Development Department issued the order late Wednesday, a day after Singh's existing one-year re-employment term ended on September 30. The latest order provides for his re-employment from October 1, 2026, to September 30, 2027 or until further orders.



This is the second consecutive extension granted to Singh after his superannuation. A 2009-batch IAS officer, he had retired from government service in September 2025 and was subsequently re-employed for a year as YEIDA and NIAL CEO. Singh's continuation comes at a crucial stage for the Yamuna region, with the Noida International Airport at Jewar moving towards commercial operations and YEIDA simultaneously pushing several large industrial, logistics and urban-development projects.

Singh took charge as CEO of YEIDA and NIAL in July 2025, replacing Arun Vir Singh. Before that, he had served as secretary to Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath and had earlier worked as additional CEO of YEIDA in 2015-16.

During his tenure, YEIDA has focused on bringing allotted industrial units into production, developing new industrial clusters and accelerating infrastructure around the airport. YEIDA is also pursuing logistics and urban projects, including a multimodal logistics park and new urban centres, as it accelerates development around the airport-led Yamuna City.

Jarnail Singh files defamation case against PWD Min Verma

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 1

Aam Aadmi Party MLA Jarnail Singh on Thursday filed a defamation case against Delhi PWD Minister Parvesh Verma following a row that erupted when the minister slapped a civilian during a road inspection in west Delhi's Tilak Nagar.

The party MLA sought an apology from Verma for slapping the youth, who was at the time recording him on a phone camera.

"The minister lost his cool after seeing me openly challenging his claims of the road work, and he kicked and slapped a youth in Tilak Nagar. I have filed a defamation case against Minister Verma. He has seven days to respond to why he slapped a youth and apologise," Singh said at a press conference.



Since the episode last week, an FIR has been registered against AAP's Delhi unit president Saurabh Bharadwaj and Jarnail Singh, and several party workers, for allegedly assaulting a head constable and obstructing him from discharging his duties.

The police have also filed a non-cognisable report (NCR) against Verma for slapping 22-year-old Sahib Singh during a road inspection last week. Singh sought the third-party audit report, questioning the road's poor condition even a week later.

3D VISION, PRECISION TOOLS AID PROCEDURE

Robotics offers edge in complex gallbladder surgery: AIIMS docs

SHIVANGI SHUKLA
New Delhi, October 1

Robotic-assisted surgery could increasingly replace conventional laparoscopy in gallbladder procedures, according to surgeons at the All India Institute of Medical Sciences (AIIMS), New Delhi, who have drawn on the Department of Surgical Disciplines' experience of more than 1,500 robotic-assisted surgeries.

Professor Hemanga K Bhattacharjee of the Department of Surgical Disciplines said gallbladder operations can become challenging when severe inflammation, dense adhesions, scarring from previous episodes or unexpected anatomy makes it difficult to identify and safely dissect structures.

In such cases, robotic-assisted surgery can provide enhanced visualisation and instrument control, helping surgeons navigate difficult anatomy with greater precision.



> 'TECH COULD HELP SURGEONS DEVELOP MINIMALLY INVASIVE SURGERY SKILLS BY OFFERING A DIFFERENT WAY OF UNDERSTANDING ANATOMY...'

The da Vinci system offers a high-definition, three-dimensional view and wristed instruments that allow controlled movements at different angles.

Professor Asuri Krishna, Head of Surgery Unit 4, said the technology could also help surgeons develop minimally invasive surgery skills by offering a different way of understanding anatomy and performing movements during the learning process.

Dr Sunil Chumber, Head of the Department of Surgical Disciplines, who has performed open surgery, mini-laparotomy, conventional laparoscopic surgery and robotic-assisted surgery, said robotics represented a significant step forward based on his experience.

Chumber said he expects gallbladder surgery to eventually be performed robotically, with conventional laparoscopy gradually phased out. He described this as the next step in the evolution of surgical techniques – from open surgery to mini-laparotomy and laparoscopy, and now robotics.

The robotic system remains under the direct control of the operating surgeon and does not replace the surgeon's understanding of anatomy or clinical judgement.

JNUSU delegation seeks VC action on student demands

Demands rollback of CPO manual, GSCASH restoration

ANAMTA FATIMA
New Delhi, October 1

The Jawaharlal Nehru University Students' Union (JNUSU) organised a mass delegation to the Vice-Chancellor at the university's Administrative Block, pressing for immediate action on a charter of student demands concerning academic, administrative and campus-related issues.

The students demanded the rollback of the CPO Manual and revocation of the rustication of JNUSU office-bearers, along with the reinstatement of the Gender Sensitisation Committee Against Sexual Harassment (GSCASH) and the JNU Entrance Examination (JNUEE).

The union also raised concerns over essential facilities, seeking mess and Wi-Fi services at Barak Hostel and improvements to hostel infrastructure, library seating, lifts, roads, Teflas and the stadium. It demanded an audit of mess bills, an increase in the Merit-cum-Means (MCM) scholarship and inclusion of School of Engineering students under the scheme.



> FURTHER CALLED FOR REFORMS TO THE EQUAL OPPORTUNITY CELL IN ACCORDANCE WITH THE ROHITH ACT AN ANNUAL AUDIT OF ITS FUNCTIONING...

JNUSU further called for reforms to the Equal Opportunity Cell in accordance with the Rohith Act and an annual audit of its functioning. It also sought the removal of the Siddhanta Knowledge Foundation, restoration of the JNUSU Fund and student representation in academic councils.

Among other demands, the union sought hostel accommodation for students until PhD thesis submission, proper implementation of reservation in hostel allotments and an inquiry into alleged recruitment irregularities involving IQAC and Kumaraswamy. It also demanded fee parity for SoE, MBA, Mahanadi and Married Hostels with standard JNU norms.

Separately, JNUSU met the Dean of Students over a circular asking students to clear mess dues by September 30. The union opposed the alleged "defaulter list" and demanded that such notices be withdrawn, asserting that delayed MCM and fellowship payments had contributed to students' financial difficulties.

Nuh: Six youths nabbed with illegal weapons

'Planning revenge for clash at Jamia'

Gurugram, October 1

Nuh police arrested six youths with illegal weapons as they were allegedly planning to travel to Delhi to exact revenge for an assault during a clash at Jamia Millia Islamia, officials said on Thursday.

Nuh Sadar police station registered an FIR against the accused.

According to police, the accused gathered in Salamba village to plan an attack after one of the accused, Bilal, was assaulted during a clash at Delhi's Jamia earlier this week.

Police recovered an illegal country-made 'Pauna' gun, a country-made pistol and sticks from them.

Nuh CIA arrested six youths allegedly involved in a Jamia dispute and preparing to commit a major crime while planning to travel to Delhi, police said. A case has been registered at Nuh Sadar Police Station. MPOST

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CALLS FOR DAILY HABIT

CM joins students in cleanliness drive



AIMAN FATIMA
New Delhi, October 1

A one-hour cleanliness drive at Delhi University's Kamla Nehru Ridge on Thursday saw Chief Minister Rekha Gupta join students, teachers and residents in shramdaan, as she stressed that keeping public spaces clean cannot remain limited to annual campaigns and must become part of everyday civic behaviour.

Gupta participated in the 'Ek Din, Ek Ghanta, Ek Saath' cleanliness drive under the 'Swachhata Hi Seva Abhiyan 2026'. The drive was held from 8 am to 9 am, with cleanliness and service activities being undertaken at several locations across Delhi.

Calling for sustained public participation, Gupta said, "Cleanliness should not be a one-day campaign, but a regular habit and a collective responsibility." She said that while sanitation workers and government agencies have the responsibility of ensuring regular cleaning, citizens must ensure that public spaces remain clean after they have been cleaned.

> CLEANLINESS SHOULD NOT BE A ONE-DAY CAMPAIGN, BUT A REGULAR HABIT AND A COLLECTIVE RESPONSIBILITY

"Whenever someone throws waste on a road or in a public place, they should think about how even such a small act of carelessness affects people around them and the environment as a whole," she said.

The Chief Minister said maintaining cleanliness required participation from both the administration and residents. She emphasised that sanitation agencies must perform their duties responsibly, while citizens should avoid littering roads, lanes, parks, markets and other public places.

"Employees responsible for maintaining cleanliness must perform their duties with full responsibility, while citizens also have a duty to ensure that cleanliness is maintained after an area has been cleaned," Gupta said.

The Chief Minister said her participation at Kamla Nehru Ridge and the university area alongside students, teachers and residents reflected the need for collective action on civic issues. She particularly highlighted the role of young people in taking cleanliness initiatives beyond individual events and into communities.

"Participating in the cleanliness drive at Kamla Nehru Ridge and the Delhi University area along with students, teachers and citizens is an example of this collective spirit," she said.

Delhi gets pollution war room with AI-CCTV monitoring of over 700 construction sites

AIMAN FATIMA
New Delhi, October 1

Delhi on Thursday got a new pollution-monitoring "war room" with the launch of the Delhi Pollution Control Committee's (DPCC) Integrated Command and Control Centre (ICCC), which will use AI, CCTV, GPS tracking and real-time data to monitor pollution sources and coordinate field action across the city.

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta inaugurated the centre at the Delhi Metro Rail Corporation's IT Park in Shastri Park under the Seva Sankalp Campaign. The centre will monitor pollution hotspots, construction sites and field activities while integrating complaints and inspection data to facilitate quicker action by concerned departments.

Gupta said the government's approach would be based on the principle of "Detect, Analyse, Act, Verify", under which pollution-related problems will be identified, analysed, acted upon and subsequently verified. "The focus is not merely on monitoring pollution, but on connecting technology, data and field enforcement so that information is converted into prompt action and measurable outcomes," she said.

The ICCC will provide 24x7 monitoring of more than 700 construction sites covering over 500 square metres through AI and CCTV cameras. Environment Minister Manjinder Singh Sirsa said the system would alert the concerned department and site owner if PM10 levels rise at monitored sites.

Sirsa said the centre had been completed in less than six months and would function as a war room during the winter pollution season. It will also monitor AQI stations, analyse previous years' data and track local pollution sources.

The centre will track GPS-enabled mechanical road sweeping machines, including their locations, routes, operating hours and distance covered. New cameras will also be used to monitor open waste and biomass burning.

Field enforcement will be linked directly to the command centre. Seventy-eight sub-division-level teams will undertake monitoring and enforcement during winter, with their movements tracked through GPS-enabled vehicles. 'Vayudoot' teams involved in identifying pollution-causing activities will use body cameras connected to the ICCC.

Body cameras have also been made mandatory for DPCC officials conducting inspections of industries and other polluting sites, with the government saying this would improve transparency and accountability.

The Chief Minister also launched the 'Jan Suggestion' portal, through which citizens can submit pollution-related complaints, suggestions and information about initiatives aimed at reducing pollution.

Sirsa said 72 lakh trees had already been planted against the government's target of 70 lakh. He said officials would be deployed at the ICCC round the clock in shifts during winter.

MLA Arvinder Singh Lovely and other officials were also present at the inauguration.

Union Ministers join NDMC's cleanliness drive

ANAMTA FATIMA
New Delhi, October 1

Union Ministers Kiren Rijiju and G. Kishan Reddy, along with Delhi Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh, participated in cleanliness drives in the New Delhi Municipal Council (NDMC) area on Thursday as part of the "Ek Din, Ek Ghanta, Ek Saath" initiative under the Swachhata Hi Seva 2026 campaign.

Rijiju joined the shramdaan programme at Navyug School on Peshwa Road near Gole Market along with NDMC Chairman Manoj Kumar Dwivedi. Students, teachers and residents participated in the drive, which was followed by a tree plantation programme.

Reddy participated in a cleanliness drive at Yashwant Singh Place in Chanakyapuri along with senior officials of the Ministry of Coal and Mines. He interacted with NDMC sanitation workers and felicitated them for their contribution to maintaining cleanliness.

Meanwhile, Parvesh Sahib Singh inaugurated NDMC's largest community toilet facility at Jodhpur Mess on Pandara Road. Built at a cost of about Rs 1 crore with NBCC's CSR support, the facility has separate sections for men and women, CCTV cameras and other provisions for hygiene and safety. Singh also participated in a shramdaan programme at Hanuman Mandir in Connaught Place and appealed to devotees to maintain cleanliness around the temple.

The NDMC Health Department, in collaboration with the Delhi Police and CRPF, organised a cleanliness drive at the National Police Memorial in Chanakyapuri. About 120 participants took part, removing nearly 300 kg of waste and silt from the memorial, Pt. Uma Shankar Dixit Marg and adjoining areas.

Rohini gets new DDA sports complex

SHIVANGI SHUKLA
New Delhi, October 1



The DDA Sports Complex in Sector 33, Rohini, was inaugurated on Wednesday by Delhi Lieutenant Governor Sardar Taranjit Singh Sandhu, adding a range of indoor and outdoor sporting facilities for residents of Rohini, Outer Delhi and adjoining areas of North West Delhi. The L-G also laid the foundation stone for an Electric Vehicle (EV) Charging Station at the complex and announced the L-G Cup for Hockey, which will be held from October 9 to 18. The tournament is aimed at encouraging young athletes and promoting greater participation in team sports such as hockey.

Spread over approximately 8.11 hectares, the complex has a built up area of around 10,974 sqm. Its outdoor facilities include six lawn tennis synthetic courts, two basketball synthetic courts, netball and volleyball courts, a skating rink, a natural turf cricket ground, two cricket practice nets with clay pitches, a football cum hockey ground and a jogging track. The indoor section has facilities for table tennis, yoga, aerobics and gymnasium, besides multipurpose halls, a conference hall, reception and waiting hall and a first aid room. The complex also has a pro shop, around 1.3 km of internal peripheral road and parking for 155 ECS.

The facility will initially operate on a Pay & Play basis, while memberships will subsequently be invited/opened. More facilities are planned, including a Gym/Fitness Centre and Rehabilitation Centre on the first floor, a swimming pool in Phase-II and dedicated badminton facilities.

After the inauguration, Sandhu visited the DDA Aarambh Library in Rohini and interacted with students. With demand for the facility, he announced that an upper floor would be utilised to create more than 40 additional seats. DDA currently operates five Aarambh Libraries at Old Rajinder Nagar, Adhchini Village, Dwarka, Rohini and Vikaspuri.

Briefs

MCD to deploy 70 mechanised road sweepers

NEW DELHI: The Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) is set to deploy 70 mechanised road sweeping machines across the city from mid-November as part of measures to strengthen sanitation and tackle dust-related air pollution during the upcoming vulnerable season. MCD Commissioner Sanjeev Khirwar on Thursday inspected field trials of newly procured Electric Vehicle (EV) Mechanical Road Sweeping Machines (MRSMs), which have been airlifted to Delhi for testing. The project, supported by the Department of Environment, Delhi government, includes 55 EV-based and 15 CNG-based machines.

MCD clears solar plan

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Municipal Corporation has approved a unified rooftop solar plan to equip approximately 1,100 civic buildings with solar power without any direct capital expenditure, officials said on Thursday. The civic body in its House Meeting cleared the proposal on Tuesday, allowing Indraprastha Power Generation Company Limited (IPGCL) to undertake feasibility assessments and install solar systems at eligible municipal properties under the Delhi Solar Energy Policy, 2023.

CM launches 'Main Bhi Yamuna Prahari' app



OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 1

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Thursday launched the 'Main Bhi Yamuna Prahari' mobile application at the Delhi University Sports Complex, seeking greater participation of students and citizens in efforts to clean and conserve the Yamuna.

Launched under the Seva Sankalp Campaign, the app will allow citizens, students, teachers and social organisations to register for the campaign. Gupta said the restoration of the Yamuna could not be left to government agencies alone and required sustained participation from residents, particularly the youth.

She announced that thousands of students from 30 Delhi University colleges will come together on October 18 to take a pledge for the cleanliness and conservation of the river. Gupta urged students to take the campaign beyond their campuses and involve their families and communities.

"Cleaning the Yamuna is not only the government's responsibility," Gupta said, adding that citizens' everyday practices also contribute to pollution. She cited the immersion of puja material, flowers, garlands, damaged idols and other items in the river as practices that add to the pollution burden. Union Minister of State Harsh Malhotra said the cleanliness of the Yamuna required collective participation.

EUPHORIA TO PERFORM

Raahgiri Day on Oct 4: No cars in CP's Inner Circle

ANAMTA FATIMA
New Delhi, October 1

Connaught Place's Inner Circle will turn into a car-free public space on October 4, with cycling, fitness activities, music and street performances planned as part of Raahgiri Day.

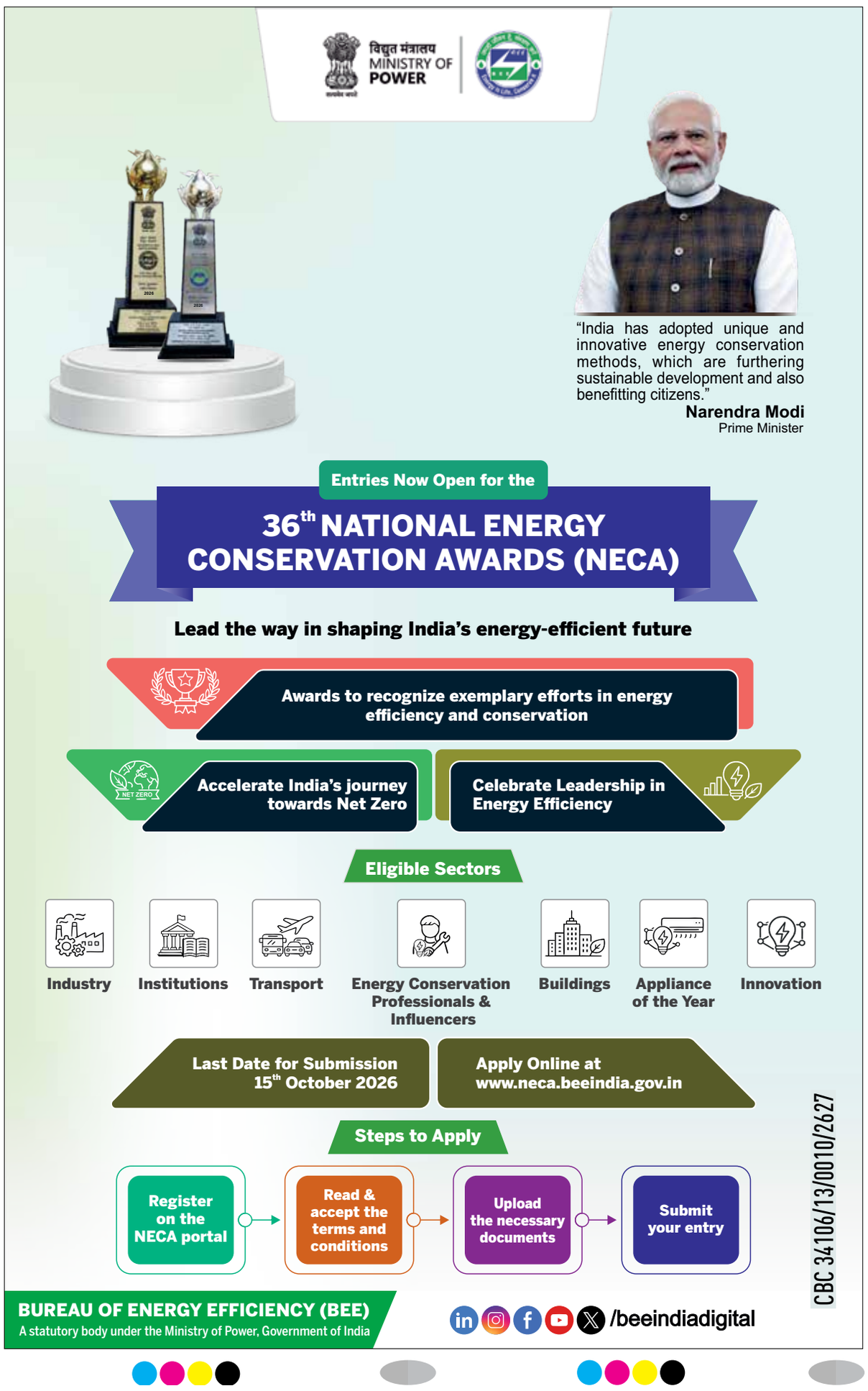
The event, organised by the Raahgiri Foundation, Delhi Traffic Police and Fit India in association with the New Delhi Municipal Council (NDMC), will see motorised vehicles make way for pedestrians and cyclists.

A key attraction of the programme will be a live performance by Indian rock band Euphoria at Central Park. The event will also feature performances by local artists and a range of activities aimed at encouraging community participation.

The programme is being held in partnership with Fit India's 'Sundays on Cycle' initiative, under which citizens will be encouraged to participate in community cycling drives and fitness activities. Demonstrations on walkability, cycling and non-motorised transport will also be organised along the Inner Circle.

The organisers have planned interactive workshops, sports and fitness activities, street art and other public engagements through the day. Activities focusing on youth participation, civic engagement and environmental stewardship will also form part of the programme.

The event will also serve as a curtain-raiser for Urban Adda '26, a three-day urban transformation conference scheduled to be held at the India Habitat Centre from October 5 to 7.



ONOE panel shelves SC visit amid Oppn objections over separation of powers

'The visit had been put off as the dates of committee members did not match'

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, October 1

A parliamentary panel examining the 'One Nation, One Election' bills has shelved its proposed visit to the Supreme Court on October 6 for an interaction with judges on the legislation, committee chairman P P Chaudhary said on Thursday amid concerns raised by Opposition leaders over separation of powers.

Chaudhary told PTI that the visit had been put off as the dates of committee members did not match.

"I also have other commitments to attend to," he said.

The proposed visit had drawn objections from the Opposition, with at least one member of the joint committee writing to Chaudhary seeking its cancellation, it is learnt.

The MP is learnt to have argued that an interaction with the Chief Justice of India or other sitting judges on the constitutional validity or merits of the proposed legislation could raise concerns over the separation of powers and the institutional independence of Parliament and the judiciary.



Joint Parliamentary Committee Chairman P.P. Chaudhary addresses a press conference on the 'One Nation, One Election' initiative, in Lucknow, on Wednesday

The member is also learnt to have pointed out that the legislature's role in considering and making laws should remain distinct from the judiciary's role in adjudicating their validity, and that seeking the views of sitting judges on legislation which could subsequently come before the Supreme Court for judicial scrutiny could create an avoidable institutional overlap.

Earlier in the day, Independent Rajya Sabha member Kapil Sibal publicly raised similar objections to the proposed visit, calling it "unconstitutional" and contrary to the concept of separation of powers.

Sibal, a senior advocate, said he had never come across a parliamentary panel holding an interaction with Supreme Court judges over proposed legislation that could later come before the court for adjudication.

He claimed a programme circulated by the Chaudhary-led committee listed a "local study visit" to the Supreme Court on October 6, including an informal discussion with the CJI and other judges on simultaneous polls.

Sibal argued that while it was Parliament's prerogative to enact laws, it was for the judiciary to subsequently examine their constitutional validity if challenged.

Parliamentary panels have, however, interacted with sitting Supreme Court judges in the past.

In 2022, the Parliamentary Standing Committee on Personnel, Public Grievances, Law and Justice, then headed by BJP MP Sushil Kumar Modi, met then Chief Justice of India U U Lalit and Justice D Y Chandrachud to discuss issues related to e-courts.

The Sushil Modi-led panel again visited the Supreme Court in March 2023 and interacted with CJI Chandrachud and other judges on the functioning of the National Legal Services Authority and access to free legal aid. The interaction lasted over two hours.

The earlier interactions, however, concerned issues relating to the administration and functioning of the judiciary and not the constitutional validity or merits of a pending legislation.

The Joint Committee is examining the Constitution (One Hundred and Twenty-Ninth Amendment) Bill, 2024 and the Union Territories Laws (Amendment) Bill, 2024, which seek to provide a framework for holding simultaneous elections to Lok Sabha and state legislative assemblies.

The two bills were introduced in Lok Sabha in December 2024 and subsequently referred to the joint committee for examination.

RS polls in UP: Akhilesh Yadav parries query on 3rd candidate

MPOST BUREAU
Lucknow, October 1

Samajwadi Party chief Akhilesh Yadav on Thursday kept the suspense alive over the likelihood of putting up a third candidate in the upcoming October 16 Rajya Sabha elections for 10 seats in Uttar Pradesh.

He attacked the BJP, which is yet to name its candidates.

"The BJP can do anything. They can field nine or even 10 candidates," Yadav said, while parrying a query on his party's plan for a third candidate, a move that would force a contest in the biennial polls and open up the prospect of cross-voting.

Rajya Sabha elections are based on proportional representation and single transferable vote, which ensures that the surplus votes of winners are transferred to remaining candidates according to their second preferences.

This is why if a contest happens with more than 10 candidates in the fray, it will boil down to technicalities and astute planning, party leaders on both sides admit.

The benchmark to win one RS seat in UP depends on the number of vacant seats up for election, and the number of active and voting MLAs, but it usually stabilises around 37 first-preference votes.

The BJP currently has 255 MLAs in the Vidhan Sabha while the SP has 101. Three MLAs who defected to the BJP are currently unattached. BJP allies Apna Dal (S) has 13 MLAs, RLD has nine, SBSP has six, Nishad has five and the Jansatta Dal Loktantrik Party has two.

The SP's partner Congress has two MLAs. Seven seats are vacant.

The term of nine members to the Rajya Sabha from UP, including two Union ministers, will end on November 25 while one seat has fallen vacant as the BJP's Dinesh Sharma quit after becoming the Lieutenant Governor of Andaman and Nicobar Islands.

The BJP along with its allies and a few other friendly parties like Raja Bhaiya's Jansatta Dal Loktantrik looks set to ensure it wins eight candidates, with the SP bagging the remaining two seats.

After a recent party meeting, SP lawmaker Ravidas Mehrotra told PTI that all MLAs favoured putting up a third candidate.

"Due to resentment against the BJP's anti-people and divisive policies, all SP MLAs are confident that we will win even if we field a likely third candidate," Mehrotra said.

Sources said the BJP has purchased eight sets of nomination papers and may name candidates over the next few days. UP BJP incharge Vinod Tawde arrived in Lucknow on Thursday once again to hold meetings with party leaders amid suspense over the names and number of candidates the party may field.

Tawde is also scheduled to meet Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath and attend the party's core committee meeting on the issue.

October 6 is the last date for filing nominations, and if the SP does put up a third candidate, it will mean 11 candidates will be in the fray. A similar scenario will emerge if the BJP fields more than eight candidates in a bid to win an extra seat to gain a psychological edge over the SP ahead of 2027 UP assembly polls.

From page 1

Eight students

"Schoolchildren have no idea about the sea. It's not a pond, it's the sea," Dalvi said, adding that children may also not know how to swim. He called for local authorities and elected representatives to examine safety arrangements at the site.

Prashant Kurhade, chairman of the Alandi Municipal Council, said some of the students were from Alandi while others came from nearby Kelgaon. He said officials were in touch with the families and some parents had already travelled to Diveagar.

Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis described the deaths as "extremely tragic and painful" in a post on X and said the local administration was coordinating the transportation of the bodies to Alandi. Disaster Management Minister Girish Mahajan ordered a probe into the incident and said new safety guidelines for school trips would be issued. Police have registered a case and further investigation is underway.

Opposition, CJP

"In an interview to a leading national daily, former CEC O.P. Rawat has questioned the SIR and the violations committed by the ECI. It is 'the first time since Independence that so many eligible voters have lost their vote'," Ramesh said on X.

Ramesh also quoted Rawat as saying the Election Commission, once regarded as the "gold standard", had suffered a loss of credibility and that the other two election commissioners should have done more to stop what he described as the CEC's "illegal decisions".

The INDIA bloc announced its joint protest programme after a meeting attended by leaders of 19 opposition parties. The plan includes 'Save Democracy' marches in districts from October 2 to 8, a march by all Opposition MPs to the Election Commission on October 6, a meeting with the President and five major rallies.

The opposition parties have also demanded that future elections be conducted using ballot papers and have sought an early hearing of cases related to the SIR and alleged electoral irregularities. Leaders at the meeting discussed the demand for Kumar's resignation and said they would continue their agitation until the demand was met.

The INDIA bloc's campaign follows a report by The Indian Express that Election Commissioners Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi had objected on record at least 14 times over 10 months to decisions and orders relating to the SIR, which they said had been issued without their knowledge or recommendation. The Election Commission has maintained that its decisions were taken in accordance with due procedure.

Separately, CJP founder Abhijeet Dipke on Thursday announced that his organisation would begin protests from October 2, with a demonstration planned at Shivaji Park in Mumbai's Dadar area. He demanded Kumar's resignation and warned that the agitation would spread to several parts of the country before moving to Jantar Mantar in Delhi from the end of October if the CEC did not step down.

Dipke said the CJP would not join the INDIA bloc's October 6 protest and would continue to operate as an independent movement. He said protests would be held in Goa, Bengaluru, West Bengal, Uttar Pradesh, Patna and Ranchi.

"CEC Gyanesh Kumar must resign and a criminal case should be registered against him," Dipke said at an interaction at the Mumbai Press Club.

On the reported denial of permission by Mumbai Police for the Shivaji Park protest, Dipke questioned why the CJP could not hold a demonstration at the venue if political rallies could be organised there.

Referring to remarks by Maharashtra Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis on the consequences of arrests during protests, Dipke said he was prepared to go to jail and return to protest again.

CJP leader Ajinkya Shinde said the organisation would take its campaign to several cities and would hold a demonstration at Jantar Mantar if Kumar did not resign.

Asked about the INDIA bloc's protest, Dipke said the CJP would not participate in any political programme but welcomed the opposition's campaign against alleged electoral irregularities.

The CJP has also called for a transparent process for appointing the CEC, with civil society participation, and sought the freezing of the 2025 voter list to prevent what it described as further tampering.

Meanwhile, the Maharashtra Navnirman Sena and Shiv Sena (UBT) have announced a separate protest march against the Election Commission in Mumbai on October 4.

Rahul

introduced by the Chief Election Commissioner in mid-July 2026 and claimed they were intended to remove Gen Z voters from electoral rolls. He attributed the move to Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Union Home Minister Amit Shah.

Delhi sees most

conditions likely to remain between moderate and satisfactory for the next six days. It said low ventilation and wind speeds can restrict pollutant dispersion and cause accumulation near the surface.

Farm fires also continued in neighbouring states. The Indian Agricultural Research Institute recorded 14 incidents in Madhya Pradesh, five in Uttar Pradesh and four in Punjab on Thursday. A total of 137 incidents have been reported since September 15, including one in Delhi.

Delhi's maximum temperature at Safdarjung was 35.2 degrees Celsius, while the minimum was 24 degrees. For Friday, mainly clear skies are expected, with temperatures likely to range between 23 and 34 degrees Celsius.

NCERT

every citizen" and explains that tax revenue contributes to the country's development.

The chapter, "Managing Your Personal Finances", says financial management begins in childhood. It covers decisions involving spending, saving, investing, insurance, borrowing and taxation, noting that such choices can affect an individual's financial stability.

A table in the chapter lists the income tax slabs under the new regime, followed by a step-by-step explanation of how to calculate tax liability. The old tax regime is not discussed.

Introduced in the Union Budget in February 2020, the new regime took effect from the financial year 2020-21. It provides lower tax rates while limiting most exemptions and deductions. It became the default tax regime from April 1, 2023, unless taxpayers choose the old system.

The chapter also explains five pillars of personal finance: income, budgeting, saving, investing, and protection and risk management. Under early investment options, it lists fixed deposits, bonds, stocks and mutual funds.

ICICI veteran Anup Bagchi

Non-executive chairman Atanu Chakraborty resigned in March, citing concerns related to values and ethics. Subsequent disclosures included issues involving product misselling at its Dubai branch and incentives linked to deposit mobilisation.

Jagdishan, whose six-year tenure ends with his departure, opted out of seeking another term in August. The bank had submitted two candidates to the RBI.

Bagchi's appointment requires shareholder approval under the Companies Act, 2013. HDFC Bank's American depositary receipts rose more than 5 per cent after the announcement.

MEA says Smit

the bloodied pilot, spread widely online.

Ministry of External Affairs said Machchhar received initial treatment at a hospital in Tabuk and has since been moved to Abu Dhabi for continued care. Indian ambassador to the UAE Deepak Mittal met him in hospital and earlier met his family, assuring them of all possible support. "Very reassured to meet Capt Smit," Mittal said in a post on X, adding that the pilot is in good health and recovering well. The ministry said its embassy in Abu Dhabi and consulate in Dubai are in close touch with local authorities, and it thanked the UAE government for the medical care provided.

In the UAE, Attorney-General Hamad Al Shamsi ordered a team of specialised Public Prosecution members to examine the circumstances and causes of the incident. The Foreign Ministry said UAE courts have jurisdiction because the aircraft is registered in the country and flies its flag, so UAE law applies to crimes committed on board even outside its territory. The team is working with the General Civil Aviation Authority. Authorities want to establish whether the incident "was linked to any terrorist activity or purpose or involved prior planning or direction", state news agency WAM reported. The ministry thanked Saudi authorities for their handling of the landing and asked the public to rely on official sources and avoid circulating speculation until the inquiry ends.

The co-pilot, believed to be an Omani national, was arrested and is being questioned by Saudi authorities. Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu told Fox News it was too early to say who was behind the incident and that Israel may take part in the investigation.

In India, tributes came from President Droupadi Murmu and Prime Minister Narendra Modi, who praised his "selfless act" and "presence of mind". US President Donald Trump and Netanyahu also paid tribute. Special prayers were held at the Somnath temple in Gujarat, where the trust performed a Mahamrityunjaya Mantra Japa for his health, and in Varanasi, where monks prayed with his photograph. Cricketers Sachin Tendulkar and Yuvraj Singh also praised him. Singh wrote that "some moments show you what a person is truly made of." On social media, users compared him to Neerja Bhanot, the flight attendant who died saving passengers from a hijacked plane in 1986.

Little was known about Machchhar before the incident. His LinkedIn profile says he has been a captain on flydubai's Boeing 737 fleet since June 2022, after 11 years at SpiceJet, and has logged 9,750 hours on the 737-800 and 737 MAX 8 and 9. It also lists work as a line training captain, assessing and mentoring other pilots. He studied management online at Welingkar Institute in Mumbai in 2007-08, and its director, Dr Pankaj Natu, called him a "true hero in the skies." SpiceJet said his "heroism saved countless lives".

In Ghatkopar, Mumbai, neighbours and friends described him as calm and composed since childhood and as a caring father of two. Childhood friend Prateek Gandhi said he was the most "sorted out" kid in their housing society. Crowds carrying the tricolour gathered outside his parents' home, and his parents left to be with him. Residents said they were praying for his recovery and for his family.

Flydubai said an altercation occurred on the flight deck and that crew members travelling on board intervened to secure the aircraft. Media reports have referred to a small group of crew who assisted Machchhar, but the details available so far do not name them or confirm how many there were.

India to open WC

Zimbabwe on October 24.

India are in Group A alongside Australia, Pakistan, Zimbabwe, Afghanistan and one qualifier. Group B features England, co-hosts South Africa, New Zealand, Bangladesh, Sri Lanka and the other qualifier.

The tournament will then enter the Super 7s from October 25, with the top three teams from each group and the better-placed fourth team progressing. India have been assigned A1, Australia A2 and Pakistan A3 based on the predetermined seeding system.

That could set up another India-Pakistan showdown on November 7 in Cape Town if both sides reach the Super 7s. India are also scheduled to face Australia again, this time at Victoria Falls in Zimbabwe on October 28.

The World Cup will be a demanding test of consistency. A team must play 11 matches to reach the final, making the championship match its 12th game.

The semi-finals are scheduled for Cape Town and Centurion on November 17 and 18, with the final at the Wanderers on November 21.

ICC Chairman Jay Shah said the release of the schedule and opening of the ticket ballot marked key steps towards the tournament. He said the ICC was seeking to make matches accessible to families, young fans and local communities through affordable ticket options.

The tournament will span 12 venues across South Africa, Zimbabwe and Namibia. South Africa will host matches in Cape Town, Paarl, Johannesburg, Tshwane, Bloemfontein, Durban, KuGompo City and Gqeberha, while Zimbabwe will use Victoria Falls, Harare and Bulawayo. Namibia's Cricket Ground in Windhoek will host three group games and three Super Series matches.

ATF prices

Jet fuel can account for up to 40 per cent of an airline's operating expenses, making the latest move significant for carriers.

Commercial LPG rates were also raised after a Rs 9.50 increase last month. Prices had fallen by Rs 192 in August and Rs 183.50 in July after reaching Rs 3,113.50 per cylinder in June. Between February and June, rates had risen by Rs 1,373.

The monthly revisions reflect international prices and rupee-dollar movements, with state taxes causing variations. Household LPG prices remained unchanged at Rs 942 per 14.2-kg cylinder. Petrol and diesel prices also remained unchanged after their Rs 7.50 per litre increase in May.

GST mop-up

GST refunds fell 3 per cent from a year earlier to Rs 27,001 crore during the month. After accounting for refunds, net GST collections grew 18.1 per cent to over Rs 1.76 lakh crore.

September marked the third month of the current fiscal year when gross GST collections crossed the Rs 2 lakh crore threshold. Collections had reached about Rs 2.43 lakh crore in April and over Rs 2.11 lakh crore in July.

For April-September, gross GST collections rose 11.6 per cent to more than Rs 12.46 lakh crore, while net collections increased 10.4 per cent to over Rs 10.66 lakh crore.

'Dipke detained briefly after being spotted with placards'

MPOST BUREAU
Mumbai, October 1

Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) founder Abhijeet Dipke was detained at Marine Drive police station for a brief while on Thursday after he was spotted with placards along the iconic promenade.

Dipke had gathered at Marine Drive along with a group of supporters holding placards, an official said.

"A team which included a woman inspector approached Dipke and escorted him to Marine Drive police station in a van. The woman officer asked him about his identity and hometown during the ride to the police station," the official said.

Dipke and his supporters were kept at the police station's waiting area. After being asked to meet senior officials, Dipke exited the police station minutes later smiling.

A video of Dipke's brief "detention" went viral on social media.

UPSC CENTENARY CELEBRATIONS

PM: Service delivery models must evolve to match speed of instant-delivery world

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, October 1

Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Thursday said traditional service delivery models must evolve to match the speed of an instant-delivery world where citizens demand rapid, real-time solutions powered by AI.

Urging a fundamental shift in recruitment philosophy, he stressed that the selection parameters must evaluate not just academic knowledge, but the underlying motivation to ensure candidates are drawn to public service rather than mere public office.

He said the recruitment exam must go beyond testing what a candidate knows, and also look into why that youth aspires to join the civil services. PM Modi said that an increasingly urbanised nation with narrowing rural-urban divides will dramatically elevate the expectations of the youth.

He warned that traditional service delivery models must evolve to match the speed of an instant-delivery world where citizens demand rapid, real-time solutions powered by artificial intelligence (AI).

"The aspirations and expectations of our citizens, especially our youth, will be significantly greater. The signs of this transformation are already visible. Therefore, the question today is not merely one of service delivery. The question is also whether public services are able to keep pace with the speed of today's world of instant delivery. Are they able to move at that pace?" PM Modi asked.

Today, he said, citizens do not want to wait weeks or months for a service.

"When AI can process thousands of documents within moments, and when governments have access to real-time data, citizens expect quick solutions," the prime minister said addressing the centenary celebrations of the Union Public Service Commission (UPSC) here.

He said this changing mindset also demands new changes from our civil services and therefore, we must align our selection parameters and recruitment processes with the needs of the future. Discarding the archaic 'Mai-Baap' governance mindset of the past, PM Modi heralded a modern administrative era built on the absolute principle of 'Nagrik Devo Bhava' - treating the citizen as divine.

Highlighting the urgency of administrative overhauls, the prime minister insisted that examination agencies must rapidly align with the nation's broader reform momentum by adopting the principle of time certainty to shorten exam cycles without lowering standards.

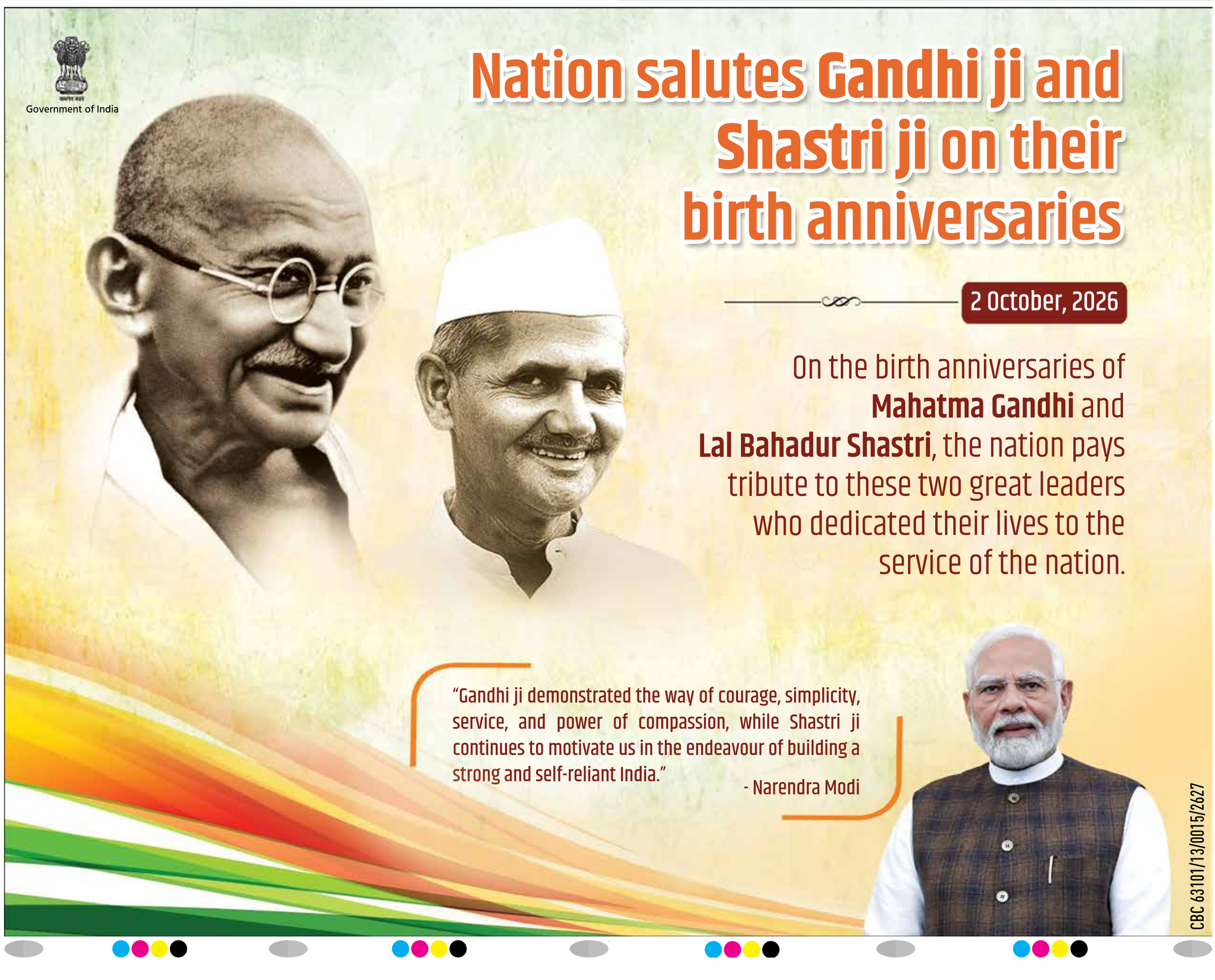


PM Narendra Modi being felicitated by UPSC chairman Ajay Kumar during the UPSC centenary celebrations, in New Delhi PTI

HIGHLIGHTS

- PM Modi said the recruitment exam must go beyond testing what a candidate knows, and also look into why that youth aspires to join the civil services
- PM Modi said that an increasingly urbanised nation with narrowing rural-urban divides will dramatically elevate the expectations of the youth





FOCUS ON CYBER, SPACE AND AI

HQ IDS marks 25 yrs, eyes greater synergy across emerging domains

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, October 1

New Delhi: The Headquarters Integrated Defence Staff (HQ IDS), which played a key role in coordinating India's tri-service efforts during Operation Sindoor, completed 25 years on Thursday, with the apex institution marking its silver jubilee by highlighting its role in strengthening jointness and preparing the armed forces for emerging domains such as cyber, space and artificial intelligence.

Conceived as a permanent institutional mechanism to promote jointness, integration and synergy among the three services, HQ IDS was established on October 1, 2001. Over the past 25 years, it has evolved as a key platform for enhancing coordination among the Army, Navy and Air Force and advancing integrated warfighting capabilities.

The institution observed its silver jubilee as Tri-Service Day with celebrations themed "Future Readiness Through Jointness and Integration". As part of the programme, HQ IDS organised "Trishakti Manthan", featuring addresses by Chief of Defence Staff and Secretary, Department of Military Affairs, Gen N S Raja Subramani, and Chief of Integrated Defence Staff to the Chairman, Chiefs of Staff Committee, Air Marshal Tejinder Singh, the Defence Ministry said.

The deliberations highlighted HQ IDS's contribution to operational preparedness through joint operational doctrines, joint training frameworks, integrated exercises and improved coordination of humanitarian assistance and disaster relief mechanisms, it said.

A silver jubilee coffeetable book documenting the evolution and achievements of HQ IDS over the past 25 years was released at a function in Delhi. A film showcasing the institution's key milestones since its establishment was also screened.

Former CDS Gen Anil Chauhan, who headed HQ IDS during Operation Sindoor last year, along with former Chiefs of Integrated Staff Committee and senior officers from the three services, attended the event.

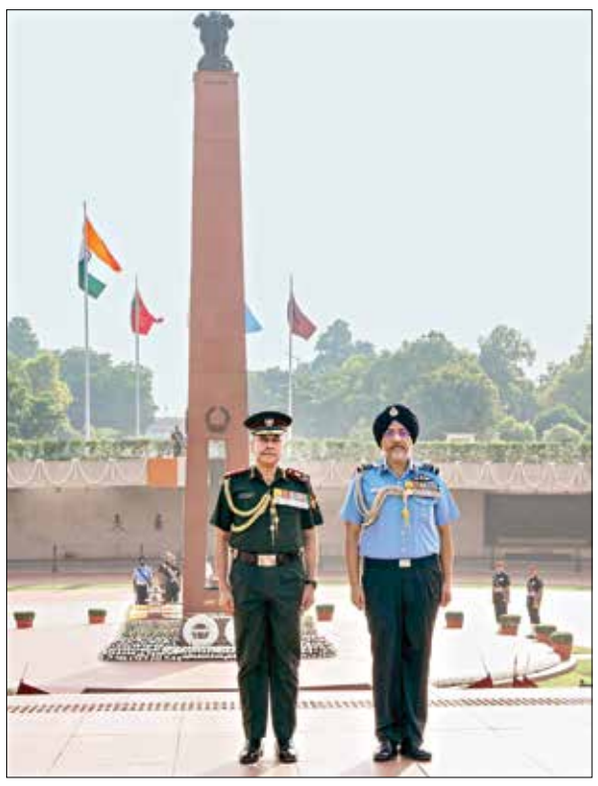
The occasion marked a significant milestone in the journey of HQ IDS and reaffirmed its commitment to building a future-ready and integrated defence force, the ministry said.

The prestigious CDS Unit Citations and CDS Unit Appreciations were also conferred on personnel in recognition of their contributions towards strengthening jointness and integration.

Earlier in the day, Gen Raja Subramani laid a wreath at the National War Memorial and Museum to pay tribute to soldiers who made the supreme sacrifice in service of the nation.

HQ IDS has also played a significant role in preparing the armed forces for emerging domains, including cyber, space and artificial intelligence. It has promoted collaboration with research organisations, academia and industry to accelerate indigenous capability development in line with the government's focus on self-reliance in defence, the ministry said.

The institution has strengthened mechanisms for jointness through platforms such as Ran Samwad, the Joint Commanders' Conference and the Combined Operational Review and Evaluation Programme. These forums facilitate structured deliberations on contemporary security challenges and contribute to enhancing joint war-fighting capabilities across land, maritime, air, space, cyber and cognitive domains.



CDS General N S Raja Subramani and Chief of Integrated Defence Staff to the Chairman Chiefs of Staff Committee (CISC) Air Marshal Tejinder Singh at the National War Memorial PTI

HIGHLIGHTS

- The apex tri-service institution, established on October 1, 2001, observed its silver jubilee as Tri-Service Day
- The celebrations, themed 'Future Readiness Through Jointness and Integration', featured deliberations on enhancing operational preparedness and strengthening coordination among the Army, Navy and Air Force
- The discussions focused on HQ IDS's contribution to joint operational doctrines, training frameworks, integrated exercises and humanitarian assistance and disaster relief mechanisms
- The occasion marked a significant milestone in the journey of HQ IDS and reaffirmed its commitment to building a future-ready and integrated defence force'

BIHAR SEEKS IAF HELP

Gandak remains above highest flood level at several locations

MPOST BUREAU
Patna, October 1



The Gandak river continued to flow above its previous highest flood level (HFL) at several locations in Bihar on Thursday, putting intense pressure on embankments following heavy rainfall in Nepal and Uttar Pradesh, the Water Resources Department (WRD) said.

At Dumariaghat in Gopalganj, the river remained around 22 cm above its previous all-time HFL for nearly 36 hours. At Revaghat in Saran and Lalganj in Vaishali, the water level was around 22 cm above the previous HFL for nearly 21 hours.

The WRD said a breach occurred in the right embankment in Panapur block of Saran on Wednesday night, while a ring embankment of the Tirhut Main Embankment in Sahebganj block of Muzaffarpur also breached.

"The Ganga is also flowing above the danger mark, creating backflow pressure in the Gandak and further aggravating the situation. Seepage and piping have been reported at several vulnerable points," the department said, adding that intensive flood-fighting and round-the-clock monitoring were underway.

Although the Gandak level has started receding, it remains above the previous HFL and hydraulic pressure is expected to persist for the next 48 hours. Other vulnerable locations were reported to be safe and under control.

Chief Minister Samrat Choudhary inspected the rising Ganga at J P Ganga Path in Patna and directed officials to maintain round-the-clock vigil and ensure public safety. He also reviewed relief preparations and said the government had approached the Indian Air Force for assistance in rescue and relief operations.

HP puts monsoon losses at Rs 3,200 cr

ASHWANI SHARMA
Shimla, October 1



The Himachal Pradesh government has estimated losses of around Rs 3,200 crore due to monsoon-related disasters, including flash floods, landslides and other calamities, and sought revised relief norms from the Centre.

In a memorandum submitted to a seven-member inter-ministerial team led by Union Home Ministry Joint Secretary M Ramachandrudu, the state urged greater assistance considering its distinct geographical and climatic conditions.

Chief Minister Sukhwinder Singh Sukhu, who met the team, highlighted the increasing impact of climate change and called for a scientific study into the rising incidence of cloudbursts. He said disaster relief criteria should reflect the specific challenges faced by hill states.

Revenue Minister Jagat Singh Negi sought increased central funding for preventive mitigation, saying post-disaster assistance alone could not address recurring landslides, flash floods and other risks. Negi said Himachal needed at least Rs 1,000 crore annually for mitigation works.

Briefs

Man gets brain report for knee scan

GHAZIPUR: A BJP functionary in Ghazipur received a brain MRI report after undergoing a knee scan at a government hospital. Raju Mishra, BJP mandal general secretary, had paid Rs 3,500 for the scan. The hospital later issued a knee report and called him for another MRI, saying the mix-up would be investigated.

AMU stir enters 11th day

ALIGARH: An indefinite protest by a group of students at the Aligarh Muslim University (AMU), seeking restoration of the students' union, entered its 11th day on Thursday. The protesters blocked entry to the Maulana Azad Library for hours, before it was reopened in the afternoon. The protest also includes a hunger strike by suspended postgraduate student Yasir Fahad.

Sex racket busted in Latur

LATUR: A prostitution racket was busted by the Anti-Human Trafficking Unit (AHTU) of Latur police, an official said on Thursday. A minor girl and three women were rescued in the raid carried out on a premises along Ambajogai road on September 30, while two persons were booked for operating the racket.

Yadav invites PM to MP Global Investors Summit



SATYAPRAKASH SHARMA
New Delhi, October 1

Madhya Pradesh Chief Minister Mohan Yadav on Thursday met Prime Minister Narendra Modi in New Delhi and briefed him on the state's ongoing development projects, public welfare initiatives, achievements, investment prospects and overall progress.

During the meeting, Yadav invited the Prime Minister to attend the Global Investors Summit scheduled to be held in Madhya Pradesh in the first quarter of the next year. He apprised Modi of the state government's efforts to create a conducive investment environment, accelerate industrial development and generate employment opportunities.

Yadav further shared details of the Seva Sankalp Abhiyan, which has been underway across Madhya Pradesh since September 17, highlighting various programmes and activities organised under the campaign.

He informed the Prime Minister about initiatives undertaken to promote public participation, voluntary service and public welfare through the month-long campaign.

The Prime Minister's Office shared the picture of the meeting on its social media handles.

Accused in VHP leader murder case deported from UAE

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 1

Intelligence agencies have secured the deportation of Harwinder Kumar alias Sonu Barnala from the United Arab Emirates in connection with the murder of VHP leader Vikas Prabhakar in Nangal, Punjab.

Prabhakar was allegedly shot dead by suspected Babbar Khalsa International (BKI) operatives in an attack linked to an alleged conspiracy to create communal tension in the state. The attack was allegedly directed by BKI chief Wadhawa Singh alias Babbar, based in Pakistan.

A Red Corner Notice was issued against Barnala on April 17, 2026. Following a request from Indian agencies on June 19, UAE authorities handed him over to India.

Mamata, Abhishek allege tampering of roll, poll machinery centralisation

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE
New Delhi, October 1



Former West Bengal chief minister Mamata Banerjee and her party's national general secretary Abhishek Banerjee on Thursday launched a sharp attack on the Election Commission, alleging tampering of the electoral roll, overcentralisation of the electoral process and lack of transparency in counting.

Addressing a press conference here, they alleged that the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) had resulted in legitimate voters being deleted from electoral rolls or being marked as having "logical discrepancies". Citing figures from several West Bengal districts, including East Burdwan, West Burdwan, Paschim Medinipur and Hooghly, Mamata Banerjee questioned changes in voter numbers and their possible impact on the Assembly election results.

She demanded a booth-wise and polling-station-wise examination of the electoral rolls, while questioning the use of software and artificial intelligence in the revision process.

"The whole election process was decentralised before. Now it is centralised," she alleged.

Mamata also questioned provisions in the 2023 law granting legal protection to the Chief Election Commissioner and Election Commissioners for acts performed in the discharge of official duties. She sought greater clarity on CCTV footage from polling and counting centres and the timing of postal ballot counting.

Abhishek alleged that in around 150 Assembly constituencies, the number of voters marked for "logical discrepancy" exceeded the winning margin. Referring to Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar, he said, "Gyanesh Kumar ji has gifted these 150 seats to the Bharatiya Janata Party."

He demanded the release of six hours of CCTV footage, from 3 pm to 9 pm, from counting centres. He also alleged that election material, including around 4,000 ballot units, 4,000 control units and 4,000 VVPAT machines, had been destroyed, and sought their preservation for possible legal proceedings.

Abhishek further alleged that software developed by Election Commission official Seema Khanna, along with AI, had resulted in around seven lakh voters being marked as having "logical discrepancies".

The Mamata faction Trinamool Congress leaders said the issue was ultimately about protecting voting rights.

CBI books two CISF officers in corruption case

NARESH BISWANI
New Delhi, October 1

The CBI has registered a corruption case against two CISF officers over alleged financial irregularities at the force's Bharat Coking Coal Limited (BCCL) unit in Dhanbad, following an internal departmental inquiry.

The case was registered by the CBI's Anti-Corruption Branch in Dhanbad on September 28 against former Deputy Commandant Om Kumar Tanwar and former Inspector (Executive) Raj Laxmi Verma. Both officers were suspended in March following departmental proceedings.

The CBI action followed a vigilance complaint filed by the CISF headquarters on the basis of a complaint by Madan Singh of the All India Coal Mines Union, Jharkhand. Singh had submitted documents and a pen drive containing three audio recordings.

According to the FIR, the recordings contain voices resembling those of the accused and allegedly relate to monetary transactions. The electronic device and related material have been included in the case records.

The departmental inquiry found alleged financial misconduct during their tenure at the BCCL unit. The CBI has alleged that the officers, while serving as public servants, obtained undue advantage and engaged in a criminal conspiracy in connection with their official duties. The case has been registered under Section 7 of the Prevention of Corruption Act, 1988 and Section 61(2) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita.

The investigation is being conducted by CBI Deputy Superintendent of Police Vikas Kumar Pathak under the supervision of SP Bhawar Lal Meena.

'India, 9 other nations bear 90% health burden of chewing tobacco'

South Asia accounts for around 84% of deaths linked to chewing tobacco, claims Lancet study

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, October 1



REPRESENTATIVE PIC

India is among the top countries with 90 per cent of the world's chewing tobacco-related health burden, and South Asia is the "epicentre" of chewing tobacco, according to new research published in The Lancet Global Health journal.

Researchers estimated that chewing tobacco contributed to 251,000 deaths globally in 2023 -- there were 241 million chewing tobacco users globally, with use peaking among individuals 60 to 64 years old, they said.

The analysis, part of the Global Burden of Disease Study 2023 (GBD 2023) and covering 204 countries and territories from 1990 to 2023, distinguishes the burden of chewing tobacco from that of other forms of smokeless tobacco, the team said.

"Chewing tobacco is not a uniform public health problem, and our findings show that a relatively small number of countries bear an overwhelming share of its health burden," lead author Gabriela Gil, research scientist at Institute for Health Metrics and Evaluation (IHME), University of Washington, US, said.

"Understanding how patterns of use differ within these populations is critical to designing more effective prevention and tobacco control strategies," Gil said.

The researchers said despite decades of progress in tobacco control, the global prevalence of chewing tobacco use has remained relatively unchanged. Stroke and lip and oral cavity cancer were found to comprise much of the health loss attributable to chewing tobacco use globally.

South Asia had the highest concentration of chewing tobacco use, with 14.6 per cent of people aged 15 years and above chewing tobacco products in 2023.

The region accounted for 2,10,000 chewing tobacco-related deaths -- about 84 per cent of the global total, the study estimated.

However, more than 90 per cent of chewing tobacco-related deaths and disability burden among men was found to occur in 10 countries, including India, Bangladesh, China, Pakistan and the US.

Among women, more than 90 per cent of the burden was concentrated in countries, including India, Bangladesh, Pakistan, Indonesia, Myanmar and China.

KEY POINTS

- Researchers estimated that chewing tobacco contributed to 251,000 deaths globally in 2023
- 'Despite decades of progress in tobacco control, the global prevalence of chewing tobacco use has remained relatively unchanged'

EDITORIAL

The Custody Clock

The Allahabad High Court's ruling that the constitutional 24-hour limit for producing an arrested person before a magistrate begins from the moment of actual detention, rather than the time entered in a formal arrest memo, reinforces a fundamental protection against arbitrary state power. Article 22(2) of the Constitution requires an arrested person to be produced before the nearest magistrate within 24 hours of arrest, excluding necessary travel time. The significance of the court's interpretation lies in recognising the reality of custody rather than allowing paperwork to determine when constitutional protection begins. If authorities could detain someone, restrict movement and exercise effective control over the person for hours – or longer – before formally recording an arrest, the safeguard could easily be rendered meaningless. A constitutional clock cannot be stopped simply by delaying paperwork.

The circumstances before the Lucknow Bench demonstrate precisely why such clarity matters. Two men were allegedly taken into custody after around 10 kg of gold was found in their vehicle following an accident in Kannauj on August 22. Their case was that they had effectively been detained from about 5.45 am that day, before being handed over to customs officials. Yet, the customs arrest memo was prepared only at 6.38 pm on August 23, and they were produced before a magistrate on August 24. Justice Subhash Vidyarthi rejected the proposition that the arrest memo alone could determine the beginning of custody. The essential question was whether the authorities had curtailed the individuals' liberty and exercised effective control over their movement. Once that threshold was crossed, constitutional safeguards became applicable. Importantly, the court also clarified that Article 22(2) is not confined to conventional police arrests. Customs and other authorities exercising powers that result in detention cannot escape constitutional requirements merely because they operate under specialised statutes.

The ruling has implications extending well beyond the particular gold seizure case. India's criminal justice system gives investigating and enforcement agencies substantial powers of search, questioning, seizure and arrest. Those powers are necessary for law enforcement, but their legitimacy depends upon strict adherence to procedural safeguards. The first hours of detention are particularly important because an individual is at the greatest disadvantage when isolated from ordinary freedoms and placed under official control. Accurate documentation of when custody actually begins must therefore become an institutional requirement rather than a procedural formality. Courts, too, must scrutinise the chronology of detention before authorising remand instead of mechanically accepting the time recorded in an arrest memo. The High Court's decision does not weaken legitimate investigation or prevent authorities from pursuing offences. It simply reiterates that constitutional protections cannot depend on how officials choose to describe custody in their records. Procedure is not an inconvenience standing in the way of enforcement; it is what separates lawful enforcement from arbitrary detention. When personal liberty is at stake, the constitutional clock must begin when liberty actually ends.

LETTER

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Full Disclosure

The Gujarat High Court's summons to Rajya Sabha MP Rajesh Shukla highlights the importance of complete disclosure in election affidavits. Voters and institutions must have access to accurate information about candidates. The allegations remain subject to judicial scrutiny, but transparency in nomination papers is essential for preserving electoral accountability and public trust.

HARSHIL MEHTA,
AHMEDABAD

You can also send your comments to The Editor, *Millennium Post*, Pratap Bhawan, 5 Bahadur Shah Zafar Marg, New Delhi 110 002

India's Growing Sleep Deficit

India's growing sleep deficit has emerged as a public-health and productivity challenge demanding greater institutional and policy attention

UNSEEN CRISIS



KDP RAO

THE WRITER IS A FORMER ADDITIONAL CHIEF SECRETARY OF CHHATTISGARH



India's sleep crisis extends far beyond individual lifestyle choices

The classic nursery rhyme "early to bed, early to rise, makes a man healthy, wealthy and wise" seems to be more relevant today than ever before. An oft-unnoticed but potentially dangerous health syndrome in today's world is sleep deprivation, which is not only affecting human health but also unleashing far-reaching economic consequences. A 2024 study in The Lancet found that consistently sleeping less than 6 hours per night is associated with a 13% increase in all-cause mortality.

According to studies, insufficient sleep results in compromised economic output through three main channels: absenteeism, presenteeism (physically present but mentally checked out), and premature mortality. Data from RAND Europe shows that the combined annual economic loss across five major OECD nations – the US, UK, Japan, Germany and Canada – exceeds $680 billion per year.

Are people able to sleep the minimum number of hours required? Perhaps not all. The WHO recommends 7 to 9 hours of sleep for adults (18-64), 8 to 10 hours for teenagers (13-18), and 9 to 12 hours for schoolchildren (6 to 12). According to a CDC study, over 70% of teenagers get insufficient sleep, while 30.5% of adults sleep under 7 hours nightly.

The situation in India is not much different, as it is ranked the second-most sleep-deprived country in the world after Japan. A study by Reme Sleep has found that 34% of Indian schoolchildren sleep for

INDIA'S CULTURE OF LONG WORKING HOURS IS EXTRACTING A HIDDEN PRICE FROM HEALTH AND PRODUCTIVITY

less than 9 hours, while 64% of Indian teenagers sleep fewer than 8 hours, mainly due to tuitions and coaching for Board exams, JEE, NEET, etc. The LocalCircles "How India Sleeps" national survey reveals that an astonishing 59% to 61% of Indian adults sleep less than 6 hours a night.

The main factors behind India's sleep crisis appear to be intense corporate hustle, a highly competitive education system, economic insecurities and modern lifestyles. Working long hours, especially in cities – the economic hubs – has become a narrative of professional excellence; but actually, it is only an 'always on' trap destroying work-life balance. Making matters worse, the digital revolution has opened the floodgates of entertainment, glueing people to screens. Round-the-clock entertainment on OTTs, 'reels' and social media has been the last straw, as blue light from screens delays the natural release of melatonin, the hormone responsible for sleep.

Most advanced countries have risen to the occasion, treating sleep as a collective resource – "sleep capital". In Europe, for example, the 'Right to Disconnect' law bans companies from penalising employees for not answering emails or messages outside standard business hours. Several states in the US have passed laws forcing high schools to start no earlier than 8:30 AM, guaranteeing children's right to sleep.

Growth is welcome, but not at the cost of sleep – a basic human right. The CDC has declared insufficient sleep a "public health problem" in the US. Sadly, in India, the government and society have not yet paid the required attention to the "sleep desert" phenomenon.

Public advocacy groups may contribute to generating awareness, but state intervention is indispensable in addressing the issues; successful campaigns on the environment and sanitation may serve as inspiring examples. Firstly, hundreds of TV channels, OTT and social media platforms need to be brought under control by regulating operational time. Secondly, all offices, except those of essential services, should close by 5 PM and shops and business establishments by 8 PM at the latest. Schools need to be restricted from opening before 9 AM, for there can be no compromise on the health needs of children, adolescents and especially girls. Strict enforcement of labour laws is equally necessary to restrain the private sector from extracting work from employees and labourers after sunset. Last but not least, political leaders can learn to be magnanimous by respecting the private time of public servants after office hours and enjoying their own as well.

Views expressed are personal

Need for a 'Serious' Contextual Read

PISA 2025 report exposed troubling declines in reading and mathematics, underlining challenges confronting education systems in an increasingly digital world

EDUCATION WATCH



JS RAJPUT

THE WRITER WORKS IN EDUCATION, SOCIAL COHESION AND RELIGIOUS AMITY



India cannot improve learning outcomes without measuring where its students actually stand globally

The global institutional learning communities very seriously study and analyse the PISA (Programme for International Student Assessment) reports. These reports are a dependable source for contextualising national strategic initiatives aimed at quality enhancement in education. Launched in 2000, PISA is an initiative of the OECD (Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development). The 2025 Report, released recently, is based upon the test scores of 760,000 15-year-old students from 91 countries and economies that participated.

India had participated only in the 2009 study, with students from Himachal Pradesh and Tamil Nadu representing the country. India ranked 73rd amongst the 74 participating nations. To avoid future global humiliation, the then HRD Minister decided to withdraw from future participation. Officially, the decision cited academic and cultural reasons, including curricular diversity and other disconnects.

The 2025 findings mainly focus on Mathematics, Reading and Science. As generally perceived, reading scores dropped sharply across the participating nations – by 28 points over a 10-year gap. Similarly, mathematics scores also dropped by an average of 22 points. In science, a drop of 7 points was found in the OECD countries, but in the remaining countries and economies, it was "broadly stable".

Around one-third – exactly 29% – of the 15-year-olds in OECD countries and economies were found to be low performers. It is well established that the performance of children is closely related to the school culture, the availability of fiscal and professional resources, and the economic, social and cultural background of the learner. The Report has comments on these aspects as well.

In India, it would not be difficult for anyone in education to find a symphony with these findings in Indian situations. Every experienced and 'regular' teacher has the same story to tell: reading habits are declining in proportion to the increase in screen time. The decline in attention span is a direct consequence of more attractive and interesting alternatives at hand! As societies become more and more digital, attention spans will decline further. All this opens

WE NEED AN EDUCATION SYSTEM CAPABLE OF COMBINING EXCELLENCE, INCLUSION, SKILLS AND LIFELONG LEARNING OPPORTUNITIES

up big challenges before educationists, text-material writers and school managements – and, of course, policymakers.

Several countries, like Germany, provide better-equipped schools for the talented. This is not done at the cost of radical neglect of the schools meant for children in general. India has very successfully created its own great example: Navodaya Vidyalayas for talented children from rural areas. The NVs have proved their worth and have clearly established that, if India could significantly enhance such schools, its cognitive capital would rise manifold within a decade or so.

We are very deficient in two constitutionally promised assurances: equality of opportunity and inclusive education. The two are linked, but also have varying vibes. What is being proposed is that talent must be nurtured, but none could be ignored, as individual variations – caused by varying economic and socio-cultural backgrounds – have a very high correlation not only with learner performance but also with the display of special interests. In the Indian psyche, families are still looking for more marks and grades in popular "academic" subject areas. The acquisition of skills, including the skill of lifelong learning, and the unlearning of skills that would become redundant in time are not issues before India alone, but practically everywhere.

India could seriously consider participation in the next PISA round. Children love to join such competitive initiatives. This participation would spare them the tensions and anxiety inflicted by participation in exams like JEE, CAT or NEET. They could be encouraged not to join coaching institutes for it. Once the school is participating, teachers would become more active and alert. Every learner inherently desires to know where he or she stands in the line of achievers and performers. This 'knowing' invariably provides internal inspiration to do better next time. One has personally observed that participation in such assessments creates a festive environment, like participating in a football or cricket match.

Expert views and opinions on the latest report are available. These obviously centre around the overwhelming impact of new technologies and emerging pedagogies that have brought visible changes in the very functioning of schools and the advent of new forms of personal learning. These observations are not unexpected.

The opinion of David Edwards, General Secretary of Education International, appears very comprehensive: "The results of PISA 2025 come as no surprise to anyone who's been paying attention to the situation in education. Our students are growing up in a world constantly vying for their attention, a world full of distractions and lacking connection."

Teacher shortage, the PISA report notes, is a global phenomenon, and India suffers an acute shortage of well-trained and regularly appointed teachers. The distractions – or attractions – for teachers are far more inviting than those for the taught.

At this juncture of unprecedented changes in teaching and learning, the need for preparing competent, committed and dynamic teachers emerges as a daunting responsibility before teacher preparation institutions. AI is pushing children away from critical thinking and analytical skills. If children move towards outsourcing their learning to machines, there would be so much to think about and worry about. Indian scholars, technical experts and scientists are, hopefully, already conscious of the social, emotional and cultural concerns.

Views expressed are personal

News at a glance

France gripped by spreading protests; PM calls meeting

PARIS: France's prime minister convened a crisis meeting on Thursday and cancelled ministers' trips to focus on the nationwide spread of protests, some violent, by high school students venting against under-resourced schools, long hours and other complaints.

The demonstrations erupted in Paris-region schools last week and have snowballed, with police making hundreds of arrests in clashes with the young protesters. Authorities have reported many dozens of injuries.

California helicopter crash kills two, 2 injured, 1 missing

LOS ANGELES: A medical helicopter crashed off Catalina Island near Los Angeles, killing two people and leaving two hospitalised, authorities said. Rescuers early Thursday searched for a fifth person who was reported to be in the aircraft and was missing, the Los Angeles County Fire Department said in a social media post.

First responders were called to the crash shortly before 8 pm Wednesday and pulled four people from the water. Two were pronounced dead at the scene and two were brough to hospitals.

Blasts in Ethiopia's capital after drone flights banned

ADDIS ABABA: A series of blasts were heard across the Ethiopian capital of Addis Ababa, hours after the government banned the use of drones and as fighting continued in the northern region of the country.

An intelligence service official, confirmed that there had been three blasts in three different locations on Wednesday night, but declined to provide further details. A diplomatic source who requested anonymity for his safety described hearing a blast at 7 pm near the defence headquarters.



People witness a fireworks display to mark the National Day of the People's Republic of China in Hong Kong on Thursday AP/PTI

Rubio ordered Iranian delegation to leave NYC ahead of schedule

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Washington, October 1

Secretary of State Marco Rubio ordered Iran's foreign minister and his delegation to the UN General Assembly to leave New York earlier than they had planned, two US officials said Wednesday.

The Trump administration had granted visas, albeit with severe restrictions, to Iran's president and foreign minister and their delegations to attend the annual meeting of world leaders despite the hostilities between the two countries.

While President Masoud Pezeshkian left New York a day after speaking at the United Nations last week, Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi had remained behind ostensibly to participate in indirect talks with the US on opening the Strait of Hormuz.

NETANYAHU CLAIMS ATTACKER UNDERWENT ISLAMIST INDOCTRINATION

Why copilot attacked captain of Israel-bound flight remains unknown

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Jerusalem, October 1

Investigators worked Thursday to determine why an Omani pilot stabbed the captain of a flight to Israel, causing the plane to plummet dangerously before others on board landed it in Saudi Arabia.

Passengers on the Fly-Dubai plane - which was carrying 174 people, mostly Israelis, from the United Arab Emirates to Tel Aviv - have described how the bloodied Indian captain managed to open the cockpit door to let them in before they grappled with the copilot and stabilised a descent so sharp that the plane's rudder was torn away.

"We felt helpless, suspended in midair, and I didn't know who to turn to. But it was all instinct to survive," Asaf Rajuan, who was among those who intervened, said in a statement shared by Israel's presidency. A regional official briefed on the investigation said the suspect, an Omani citizen, was under arrest and confirmed that Saudi authorities were working with countries, including Israel, to try to determine a motive. He said the UAE, the United States and Oman also were involved.

"All possible scenarios, from terrorism to mental disorders, are being looked into. Nothing is ruled out for now," said the official, speaking on condition of anonymity because they were not authorised to discuss an ongoing probe.



Indian Capt. Smit Machchhar in the cockpit of a plane in an unknown location PTI

KEY POINTS

- Dubai plane was carrying 174 people, most of the people were Israelis
- A regional official briefed on the investigation said the suspect, an Omani citizen, was under arrest

Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu, without giving details, claimed the attacker underwent Islamist indoctrination.

Asked who helped radicalise him, the prime minister told Fox News channel's "Fox and Friends" he did not know.

When asked by The Associated Press how the prime minister knew the copilot underwent indoctrination, Netanyahu's office said it would not comment.

The copilot has not been publicly identified. Video shot inside the plane by Shota Musayev, a dentist who treated the captain, shows the copilot on his knees, with his hands tied behind his back.

Capt Smit Machchhar, widely praised as one of the heroes of the flight, was reportedly in stable condition, the Indian Embassy in Saudi Arabia said overnight.

NORTHERN RAILWAY

E-AUCTION NOTICE

The Sr. Divisional Commercial Manager/G, Northern Railway, Delhi Division, New Delhi invites e-Auction through IREPS **(https://ireps.gov.in/)** for allotment of contracts of General Minor Units (GMUs), Special Minor Units (SMUs) for Catering Units & Multi Purpose Stall (MPS) at following railway stations/locations:

Auction Catalogue No.	Date & Time for e-Auction	Railway Station	Lot No.
MPS-SEP-02-26	15.10.2026 at 11:00 Hrs	DEE	MPS-DLI-DEE-MPS-163-25-2 MPS-DLI-DEE-MPS-131-25-2
		NZM	MPS-DLI-NZM-MPS-115-25-2 MPS-DLI-NZM-MPS-119-25-1 MPS-DLI-NZM-MPS-122-25-1
		KUN	MPS-DLI-KUN-MPS-135-25-2
		MDNR	MPS-DLI-MDNR-MPS-147-25-2
		MTC	MPS-DLI-MTC-MPS-140-25-1 MPS-DLI-MTC-MPS-141-25-1
		MUT	MPS-DLI-MTC-MPS-137-25-2

S.N.	Auction Catalogue No.	Date & Time for e-Auction	Railway Station	Lot No.	Type of Unit
1	CTG-OCT-01-26	19.10.2026 at 11:00 Hrs	Modinagar	Catg-DLI-MDNR-GMU-125-25-1	General Minor Unit (GMU)
2			Garhi Harsaru	Catg-DLI-GHH-GMU-99-25-1	
3			Mansa	Catg-DLI-MSZ-GMU-140-25-1	
4				Catg-DLI-MSZ-GMU-138-25-1	
5			Behta Hajipur	Catg-DLI-BHHZ-GMU-157-25-1	
6				Catg-DLI-BHHZ-GMU-90-25-1	
7			Khekra	Catg-DLI-KEX-GMU-105-25-1	
8			Ganaur	Catg-DLI-GNU-GMU-146-25-1	
9				Catg-DLI-GNU-GMU-133-25-1	
10			Khatauli	Catg-DLI-KAT-GMU-103-25-1	
11				Catg-DLI-KAT-GMU-129-25-1	
12			Mangolpuri	Catg-DLI-MGLP-GMU-108-25-1	
13			Julana	Catg-DLI-JNA-GMU-98-25-1	
14			Asaoti	Catg-DLI-AST-GMU-148-25-1	
15				Catg-DLI-AST-GMU-100-25-1	
16			Budhlada	Catg-DLI-BLZ-GMU-171-25-1	
17			Holambi Kalan	Catg-DLI-HUK-GMU-114-25-1	
18			Bareta	Catg-DLI-BRZ-GMU-88-25-1	
19			Fakharpur	Catg-DLI-FAP-GMU-95-25-1	
20			Maur	Catg-DLI-MAUR-GMU-151-25-1	
21			Gotra Halt	Catg-DLI-GTRA-GMU-158-25-1	
22			Khalilpur	Catg-DLI-KIP-GMU-92-25-1	
23			Gharaunda	Catg-DLI-GRA-GMU-97-25-1	

S.N.	Auction Catalogue No.	Date & Time for e-Auction	Railway Station	Lot No.	Type of Unit
1	CTG-OCT-02-26	21.10.2026 at 11:00 Hrs	Samalkha	Catg-DLI-SMK-GMU-87-25-1	General Minor Unit (GMU)
2			Tuglakabad	Catg-DLI-TKD-GMU-169-25-1	
3			Sampla	Catg-DLI-SPZ-GMU-150-25-1	
4			Mohiuddinpur	Catg-DLI-MUZ-GMU-154-25-1	
5			Mandawali Chander Vihar Halt	Catg-DLI-MWC-GMU-113-25-1	
6			Sujra Halt	Catg-DLI-SUJR-GMU-112-25-1	
7			Taj Nagar	Catg-DLI-TNJR-GMU-176-25-1	
8			Sunehra	Catg-DLI-SFA-GMU-107-25-1	
9			Vivek Vihar	Catg-DLI-VVB-GMU-109-25-1	
10			Shahabad Markanda	Catg-DLI-SHDM-GMU-131-25-1	
11			Rathdhana	Catg-DLI-RDDE-GMU-155-25-1	
12			Muradnagar	Catg-DLI-MUD-GMU-91-25-1	
13				Catg-DLI-MUD-GMU-128-25-1	
14			Uchana	Catg-DLI-UCA-GMU-110-25-1	
15			Partapur	Catg-DLI-PRTP-GMU-156-25-1	
16			Baghpat Road	Catg-DLI-BPM-GMU-102-25-1	
17			Naya Ghaziabad	Catg-DLI-GZN-GMU-132-25-1	
18			Daya Basti	Catg-DLI-DBSI-SMU-116-25-1	Special Minor Unit (SMU)
19			Delhi Azadpur	Catg-DLI-DAZ-SMU-122-25-1	
20			Palwal	Catg-DLI-PWL-SMU-166-25-1	

Website particulars where complete details of E-Auction can be seen — **https://ireps.gov.in/ (E-Auction-Leasing)**

All contractors who intend to participate in the e-auctions conducted through E-Auction Leasing module of IREPS should fulfil following mandatory requirements before they can submit their bids:

- Registration on IREPS for E-Auction Leasing module – Active IREPS User Account for E-Auction Leasing Module.
- Payment of One Time Registration Fee; Current Account in State Bank of India; Integration of SBI Bank Account with IREPS Account; Lien Marking of Funds; Updation of Turnover Details.
- A new mechanism namely **Virtual Account Number (VAN)** has been introduced now for E-Auction Leasing module, which can be used by the bidders as an alternative to Lien Marking Mechanism.
- The bidders are free to switch between Lien Marking Mechanism (if activated) and VAN mechanism at any point of time, before entering the bidding room. VAN mechanism does not require the bidder to have a current account in State Bank of India. The users are free to transfer money from any of their existing bank accounts in any bank to their VAN account, which enables them to participate in IREPS E-Auctions.
- Contractors who do not have IREPS account for any module of IREPS can submit their online request for registration by clicking on New Vendors / Contractors (E-Tender / E-Auction Leasing) link on IREPS Home page.

Railway Authority to Contact, in case of any query — Divisional Railway Manager's Office Commercial Branch, State Entry Road,New Delhi – 110055, **Email:** catering.delhidivision@gmail.com, **Tel:** 011-23743084

No. 23 AC/Ctg./e-Auction/GMU, SMU & MPS/2026 Date: 01.10.2026 **3431/2026**

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY

OPEN E-TENDER NOTICE

OPEN E-TENDER NOTICE NO. SEE26-27-(119, 132-133, 142-143 & 150-151)

The DRM (Engg.)/SEE for and on behalf of the President of India invites Open E-Tenders for the following works. The last date of online E-tendering is **23.10.2026 upto 13.00 hrs.** All information and tender documents related to E-tender is available on website - **www.ireps.gov.in**.

119. Name of works: Supplying of 60000 Cum of machine crushed track ballast 50 mm size conforming to RDSO's specification of track ballast (February-2023 edition with upto date correction slips) and loading the same into any type of Railway Wagon, F.O.R. Pakur/Bakudih/ Barharwa for Sonpur Division. **Approx Cost (In Rs.) :** 11,54,47,800.00, **Earnest Money (In Rs.) :** 23,09,000.00

132. Name of works: At HJP: Improvement of offices and officers chamber (Mechanical Department) 3rd floor at New GM building, ECR/HJP. **Approx Cost (In Rs.) :** 47,13,497.64, **Earnest Money (In Rs.) :** 94,300.00

133. Name of works: At Sonpur - Repairs and renovation of officers chamber and campus of DRM office along with parking. **Approx Cost (In Rs.) :** 99,99,997.68, **Earnest Money (In Rs.) :** 2,00,000.00

142. Name of works: Zone No. 5: Zonal works in Section: Barauni Colony under SSE(W)/Colony Barauni. (Period ending - 30.06.2027). **Approx Cost (In Rs.) :** 50,00,001.29, **Earnest Money (In Rs.) :** 1,00,000.00

143. Name of works: Provision of RCC overhead water storage tank of 50000 gallon capacity each with tube well & Pipe line each at both stations at BCA colony & DSS colony. **Approx Cost (In Rs.) :** 1,86,46,152.68, **Earnest Money (In Rs.) :** 3,72,900.00

150. Name of works: Zone No. 9: Zonal works for Section: Muzaffarpur North area & Muzaffarpur (ex.) - Hajipur (ex.) under SSE(W)/Muzaffarpur. (Period ending - 30.06.2027). **Approx Cost (In Rs.) :** 45,00,000.07, **Earnest Money (In Rs.) :** 90,000.00

151. Name of works: SEE Div:- Provision of standard height gauges at 30 LC's. **Approx Cost (In Rs.) :** 4,62,82,720.25, **Earnest Money (In Rs.) :** 9,25,700.00

The above tender notice is available on website www.ireps.gov.in. RIGHT OF RAILWAY TO DEAL WITH TENDER: Railway Administration reserves the right to postpone /modify or to cancel any one or all the tenders without assigning any reasons.

Divisional Railway Manager/Engg., Sonpur

PR/1039/SEE/ENGG/T/26-27/84

Before Debts Recovery Tribunal-II, Delhi

4th Floor, Jeevan Tara Building, Parliament Street, New Delhi-110001

Notice under section 19(4) of the Recovery of Debts Due to Bank and Financial Institutions Act, 1993 read with Rule 12 & 13 of the Debts Recovery Tribunal (Procedure Rule) 1993) in the matter of

OA NO 161/2024 **DATE: 26.05.2026**

STATE BANK OF INDIA ..APPLICANT

VERSUS

MUKESH KUMAR YADAV & ANR. ..RESPONDENT

To,

DEFENDANT

D1. MUKESH KUMAR YADAV S/O MEHAR CHAND

D2. ANJU YADAV W/O SH MUKESH KUMAR YADAV, BOTH AT: RO HOUSE NO 1799 SECT 13 HUDA BHIWANI HRY

ALSO AT: GOVERNMENT OF INDIA MINISTRY OF DEFENCE FINANCE OFFICE AT THE PRINCIPAL CDA (OFFICERS) GALIBAAR MAIDAN PUNE

ALSO AT: HOUSE NO 739 SECT 21B FARIDABAD HRY - 121001

ALSO AT : APARTMENT NO 4134 ENTIRE 2ND FLOOR OWNERSHIP NO 9 T P SCHEME NO 3 PART-1 IP EXTENSION SECT 49 FARIDABAD HRY

Whereas the above named applicant (s) has / have instituted a case for recovery of **Rs. 25,54,796/- (RUPEE TWENTY FIVE LAKH FIFTY FOUR THOUSAND SEVEN HUNDRED NINETY SIX ONLY)** against you and where as it has been shown to the satisfaction of the Tribunal that it is not possible to serve you in the ordinary way therefore, this notice is given by advertisement directing you to make appearance in the Tribunal on **06.10.2026 At 11.00 A.M.**

Take notice that in default of your appearance on the day before the mentioned, the case will be heard and determined in your absence.

All the matters will be taken up through Video Conferencing or Physical and for that purpose:-

(i) All the Advocates/Litigants shall download the **"Cisco Webex"** application / software;

(ii) **"Meeting ID"** and **Password** for the date of hearing qua cases to be taken by Hon'ble Presiding officer/Registrar shall be displayed in the daily cause list itself at DRT Official Portal **i.e. drt.gov.in.**

(iii) In any exigency qua that the Advocate/ Litigants can contact the concerned official at **Ph. No. 23748478.**

Given under my hand and seal of the Tribunal this the **26th day of May, 2026**

BY ORDER OF THE TRIBUNAL
(SURAJ PARKASH)
SECTION OFFICER, DRT-II, DELHI

SpaceX launches four astronauts on fast track to ISS

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Cape Canaveral, October 1

Four astronauts blasted off Thursday on a space station mission that will stretch until spring, among them a Canadian whose wife will give birth while he's away.

SpaceX launched commander Jessica Watkins and her crew for NASA after a three-week delay to fix the capsule's leaking fuel system.

Although their stay at the International Space Station will last a long six months, the flight there promised to be the quickest yet for Elon Musk's company: a mere eight-hour transit with an arrival well before bedtime.

SPACEX LAUNCHED COMMANDER JESSICA WATKINS & HER CREW FOR NASA AFTER A 3-WEEK DELAY TO FIX THE CAPSULE'S LEAKING FUEL SYSTEM

With the late morning liftoff from Cape Canaveral Space Force Station, Watkins became the first Black woman to lead a crew to orbit. A geologist who worked with NASA's Mars rover Curiosity a decade ago, Watkins is making her second trip to the space station following a lengthy stay in 2022.

The others are newcomers to space: NASA's Luke Delaney, a retired Marine; Canada's Joshua Kutryk, a colonel in the Royal Canadian Air Force; and Russia's Sergey Teteryatnikov, a former submariner.

They will replace four astronauts who have been living at the orbiting laboratory since February.

MADHYA PRADESH URBAN DEVELOPMENT COMPANY LIMITED

(Department of Urban Development and Housing, Government of Madhya Pradesh)
Amarkantak Bhavan, Indra Complex, M.P. Nagar Zone-1, Bhopal-462011
Ph. : 91+755-2763060, 61, 62, Fax : 91+755-2763868, Email : mpusipbpl@gmail.com
(CIN No. : U75110MP2015SGC034139)

No. : MPUDC/UDHD/2026/9801 **Dated : 01.10.2026**

INVITATION FOR BIDS

Madhya Pradesh Urban Development Company Limited (MPUDC) invites online bids on www.mptenders.gov.in/nicgep/app MPUDC-MDB tenders from eligible bidders for the following sub-projects :-

S. No.	Description	Probable Amount (in Cr.)	Bid Start Date	Bid Closing Date
1.	RFP (Request for Proposal) for Procurement of Advance Multi-Purpose Fire Tenders (22 No.)	31.90	03.10.2026	03.11.2026
2.	RFP (Request for Proposal) for Procurement of Water Bowser (21 No.)	33.60	03.10.2026	03.11.2026

2. Interested bidders may visit the website **www.mptenders.gov.in/nicgep/app MPUDC-MDB** tenders for further information and details. Invitation for Bids (IFB) for above packages can be viewed on website of MPUDC **www.mpudc.co.in** and on UDHD website **www.mpurban.gov.in.**
3. Any clarifications/further information or addenda to the Bidding Document shall be uploaded only on the above website and shall not be published separately in the newspapers.

M.P. Madhyam/128338/2026 **CHIEF ENGINEER**

NORTHERN RAILWAY

E-TENDER NOTICE

E-Tender No.: 30-TRD-NDLS-2026-27 **Dated 01.10.2026**

Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer/Traction Distribution, DRM's Office, State Entry Road, New Delhi for & on behalf of President of India, invites open e-tender for the under noted work:

1	Name of work with its location	Part-B: Provision of feeder wire for enhancement of existing OHE capacity to cater increasing load requirements of KHV/TSS of DLI Division.
2	Approx cost of work	Rs. 15,31,65,385.89/-
3	Earnest Money Deposit	Rs. 30,63,300/-
4	Pre-Bid Conference Date & Time	07.10.2026 (11.00 hrs.)
5	E-Tender Bid Online Submission Period	13.10.2026 (00.00 Hrs.) to 27.10.2026 (15.00 Hrs.)
6	E-Tender Bid Submission End Date & E-Tender Open Date & Time	27.10.2026 (15.00 hrs.)
7	Website particulars where complete details of tender documents can be seen	www.ireps.gov.in

3424/26

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

NORTHERN RAILWAY

CENTRAL HOSPITAL, NEW DELHI

OPEN TENDER NOTICE

No: 128-W-269-O.E.T-08-26-27-NRCH **Date: 30.09.2026**

The Director/Admin, Northern Railway Central Hospital, New Delhi-110055, for and on behalf of the President of India invites sealed open electronic-tenders for under noted work:-

S. No.	Name of work	Approximate cost of work	Earnest Money to be deposited	Completion period	Date of opening
1.	Operation and maintenance of all fire fighting arrangement in NRCH for 24 months in the section of ADEN/NRCH	Rs. 4499658.43	Rs. 90000/-	24 Months	27.10.2026

The e-tender is to be submit through railway website **www.ireps.gov.in**. The tenders can be submit on website up to 15:00 hrs. on 27.10.2026 and shall be opened there after.

Director/Admin/NRCH

3423/26

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

TRUMP DISTRICT OF COLUMBIA

No global oil shortage, supply route disruptions driving prices, says Puri

'There's no supply shortage in the world. The world has 104 million barrels of oil a day. It's only that the supply routes are choked'

ANI NEWS
New Delhi, October 1

Union Minister for Petroleum and Natural Gas Hardeep Singh Puri on Wednesday said the world has 104 million barrels per day of oil supply against consumption of 94 million barrels per day, but disruptions in key supply routes have pushed up freight costs and energy prices.

Speaking to the media on the sidelines of the 20th Foundation Day celebrations of the Petroleum and Natural Gas Regulatory Board (PNGRB), Puri said the current challenge in the global energy market is not a shortage of oil but disruptions to supply routes.

"There's no supply shortage in the world. The world has 104 million barrels of oil a day. It's only that the supply routes are choked and freight charges and others are high, and that's higher prices," Puri said.

He said global oil consumption is currently below available supply, with the world consuming 94 million barrels against 104 million barrels of available oil.



Union Minister for Petroleum and Natural Gas Hardeep Singh Puri

HE SAID GLOBAL OIL CONSUMPTION IS CURRENTLY BELOW AVAILABLE SUPPLY, WITH THE WORLD CONSUMING 94 MILLION BARRELS AGAINST 104 MILLION BARRELS OF AVAILABLE OIL

Puri referred to several geopolitical developments that have affected global energy markets, including the Russia-Ukraine conflict, disruptions around the Strait of Hormuz and the closure of the Red Sea route.

"When the Russia-Ukraine conflict started. That was one point. Then the next point was more serious when the Strait of Hormuz was closed," he said.

Puri said the Strait of Hormuz had emerged as a major energy chokepoint, noting that 40 per cent of global energy moves through the route.

Against this backdrop, Puri said India is also working to increase domestic oil and gas production to reduce its exposure to international energy market disruptions.

He said the first results from the government's Samudra Manthan initiative were beginning to emerge and expressed confidence that higher domestic production would help address some of the challenges faced by India because of international pricing.

"On our domestic front, I can tell you with Samudra Manthan already the first results are beginning to come in," Puri said.

He also responded to concerns over domestic production and the country's rising consumption, saying production has to be increased alongside demand growth.

"Your consumption is going up, and then if you're not investing in the well, the wells tend to lose over a period of time," he said.

Puri said India would continue working to strengthen domestic production while dealing with external risks affecting global energy markets.

He also struck an optimistic note on India's energy situation, saying the country would be able to manage the challenges with cooperation. "All I want to do is end on an optimistic note. You guys also be optimistic... I think we'll manage and we'll manage well," Puri said.

KEY POINTS

- Puri referred to several geopolitical developments that have affected global energy markets, including the Russia-Ukraine conflict, disruptions around the Strait of Hormuz and the closure of the Red Sea route
- 'When the Russia-Ukraine conflict started. That was one point. Then the next point was more serious when the Strait of Hormuz was closed,' he said
- 'India is also working to increase domestic oil & gas production to cut exposure to international energy market disruptions. On our domestic front, I can tell you with Samudra Manthan already the first results are beginning to come in'

Domestic Passenger vehicle sales rise 21% to 4.60 lakh units in Sept

The volume growth comes as carmakers ramped up supplies to dealerships ahead of peak festival season

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 1



Passenger vehicle dispatches in the domestic market are estimated to have grown around 21 per cent to 4.60 lakh units in September, with all major carmakers posting double-digit growth.

The volume growth comes as carmakers ramped up supplies to dealerships ahead of the start of peak festival season in October, while demand remained healthy. The growth also comes on a low base in last September, when sales were hit for almost 22 days ahead of GST 2.0 rollout.

The industry is estimated to have dispatched close to 4.60 lakh units during this September. "For the month of September, the industry (wholesale volume) would be around 4.60 lakh units," Maruti Suzuki India Senior Executive Officer Partho Banerjee told reporters on Thursday. "This should be growth of around 20-21 per cent. Last year's number was around 3.78 lakh units." India's largest car maker Maruti Suzuki saw its domestic passenger vehicle dispatches jump 37 per cent to 1,81,838 units last month.

Tata Motors PV emerged as the second largest player with dispatches of 68,810 units, up 15 per cent. M&M recorded 14 per cent growth in wholesales with 64,092 units, while Hyundai's wholesales grew 10.9 per cent to 57,166 units.

According to Banerjee, the industry continues to see tailwinds from lower GST rates, a reduction in repo rates, which lowered borrowing costs, as well as the change in income tax slabs. The automaker has a pending order book for 2 lakh units and network stock of 17 days. The industry is anticipating robust demand during the peak festival season, which starts with Navratri in the second week of October this year and runs till Diwali in the second week of November.

However, the growth rate could be lower in this festival season as the industry saw a pent-up demand in the year-ago festival period after new GST rates were rolled out on September 22 last year.

"Going ahead, we are expecting sustained customer enthusiasm during the festive season," Tarun Garg, MD & CEO of Hyundai Motor India, said.

CLOSER LOOK

- India's largest car maker Maruti Suzuki saw its domestic passenger vehicle dispatches jump 37% to 1,81,838 units last month
- Tata Motors PV emerged as the second largest player with dispatches of 68,810 units, up 15 per cent
- M&M recorded 14% growth in wholesales with 64,092 units, while Hyundai's wholesales grew 10.9% to 57,166 units

Kotak Mahindra Bank to elevate Saha as MD & CEO from next year

AGENCIES
Mumbai, October 1

Private sector lender Kotak Mahindra Bank on Thursday said it received RBI approval to appoint Anup Kumar Saha as managing director and CEO for three years from January 1, 2027.

Saha, currently executive director, oversees retail banking, data analytics and marketing.



Anup Kumar Saha

He previously worked with ICICI Bank and Bajaj Finance. His appointment follows incumbent MD and CEO Ashok Vaswani's decision not to seek reappointment after his term ends.

Kotak chairman C S Rajan said Saha had been actively engaged with the bank's businesses and would lead efforts to strengthen the franchise and pursue sustainable growth.

Shares rose 4.11 per cent to Rs 434.75 on BSE.

SDTT Vice Chairman Vijay Singh seeks probe into Trusts' governance, role in Tata Sons affairs

AGENCIES
Mumbai, October 1

Sir Dorabji Tata Trust (SDTT) trustee and Vice Chairman Vijay Singh has sought an immediate inquiry by Maharashtra's Charity Commissioner into the trust's governance and its involvement in Tata Sons' commercial affairs.

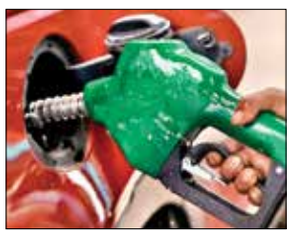
In a September 25 email, Singh sought scrutiny of trustee appointments and alleged interference with the independent decision-making of nominee directors on the Tata Sons board.

Trustee Venu Srinivasan has also written to the Charity Commissioner with similar concerns. Singh said increasing involvement of SDTT and Tata Trusts in Tata Sons' commercial and strategic affairs could jeopardise the trust's charitable status and expose its assets to tax liabilities.

He cited Tata Trusts' September 17 statements on keeping Tata Sons unlisted and a proposal to provide liquidity to the Shapoorji Pallonji Group. Singh alleged the trusts were directly involved in identifying and pursuing commercial transactions involving Tata Sons.

He also challenged a September 16 circular resolution that he said sought to restrain Srinivasan, a nominee director jointly appointed by Sir Ratan Tata Trust and SDTT, from participating in or voting on the proposed Tata Sons listing. Singh sought scrutiny of trustee appointments, Noel N Tata's chairmanship & Srinivasan's alleged exclusion from decision-making. He also sought interim directions & action, including possible suspension or removal of trustees, based on the inquiry's findings.

India to ask private fuel retailers to end rationing



AGENCIES
New Delhi, October 1

India will ask private fuel retailers to stop rationing diesel and gasoline sales, Oil Secretary Neeraj Mittal said on Thursday. "Nobody is allowed to cap fuel sales. We will tell them it is not acceptable," Mittal said.

He said the government had previously issued instructions to fuel retailers on the matter and its position remained unchanged.

Reliance Industries and Nayara Energy have restricted diesel & gasoline sales at their service stations to limit losses from selling fuels below market rates, *Reuters* reported.

India has not revised retail diesel and gasoline prices since May despite rising global oil prices. State-run fuel retailers are losing about 50 rupees/litre on diesel sales, company officials said.

Adani Green Energy expands BESS capacity to 6.63 GWh, achieves 70% of FY27 target

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, October 1

Adani Green Energy Ltd (AGEL) has expanded its operational battery energy storage system capacity to 6.63 GWh, which can store enough clean energy to power around two million homes a day.

With this, the company has achieved almost 70 per cent of the company's target for FY27. The 6.63 GWh battery energy storage system (BESS) supports peak electricity demand of cities like Nagpur, Patna or Vizag for several hours.

The company now accounts for more than 50 per cent of India's operational BESS capacity of about 12.6 GWh, AGEL said in a statement on Thursday.

The Adani Group entity said it has achieved the 6.63 GWh milestone within 14 months of commencing onsite BESSconstruction at Khavda, and is on track to add over 10 GWh of BESS capacity in 2026-27.

As of June 2026, AGEL had 3.55 GWh of operational BESS capacity. The company is targeting 50 GWh of storage capacity over the next 5 years.

The BESS uses lithium-ion battery technology, integrated with an energy management systems (EMS) and automated telemetry to manage charging and discharging, optimise system performance and support grid services.

A battery storage can improve grid stability, manage peak demand, reduce energy curtailment and enable renewable power to be delivered when required. The latest operational BESS capacity is integrated with the company's renewable energy (RE) development at Khavda, where the company is developing a 30 GW RE plant across 538 square kilometers of barren land.

Sagar Adani, Executive Director, Adani Green Energy, said, reaching 6.63 GWh of operational battery storage in just 14 months is a significant milestone for AGEL and India's clean energy transition.

BIS organises stakeholder meet on 'Circular Economy in Construction'

MPOST BUREAU
Noida, October 1

The Bureau of Indian Standards (BIS), Ghaziabad Branch Office, in collaboration with the Department of Environment and Ecology, organised a "Manak Manthan" programme at NITS, Noida, to seek stakeholder views on the Draft Indian Standard, "Circular Economy in the Construction Sector - Framework, Principles and Definitions."

G Bhavani, Scientist-F, Senior Director & Head, BIS Ghaziabad Branch Office, said stakeholder consultations make standards more practical and inclusive. Dr S Bhaskar, Scientist-G & Head, Advanced Materials Laboratory, CSIR, Chennai, highlighted circular economy's role in resource efficiency and sustainable development.

Aditya Chandra, Chief General Manager, NBCC (India) Ltd, stressed resource reuse, recycling and waste reduction, while M.R.R.N. Jindal, Chartered Engineer and Policy Expert, emphasised policy support, standardization and capacity building.

Raj Kumar, Scientist-C & Deputy Director, BIS Ghaziabad, outlined BIS's standardization and quality-protection role. Lalit Yadav, Scientist-C & Deputy Director, BIS, presented the draft standard.

A stakeholder session discussed construction waste management, recycled materials, resource efficiency and sustainable practices. Sharvan Kumar, Scientist-B & Assistant Director, BIS Ghaziabad, delivered the vote of thanks.

CORPORATE KALEIDOSCOPE



NBCC (India) Ltd recently signed an MoU with the International Divya Parivar Society (IDPS), New Delhi for the construction of the prestigious India International Cultural Centre (IICC) at Gurugram. The MoU was signed by Dr. Amit Jain, President, International DivyaParivar Society (IDPS), and Rajeev Kumar, CGM (Engg.) & SBG Head, NBCC. The project is being supported under the CSR initiative of IRFC.



NBCC (India) Ltd has signed an MoU for the FY27 on September 30, 2026 with its Administrative Ministry, MoHUA, outlining the performance targets of the Company for the FY27. The MoU has been signed by D Thara (IAS), Secretary (CD), Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs, on behalf of the Ministry and by Dr. K P Mahadevaswamy, Chairman & MD, NBCC, on behalf of the Company.



PFC organised a cleanliness drive, 'Swachhata Ke Liye Shramdaan,' at its office in New Delhi on Thursday. The drive was led by Ghanshyam Prasad, Chairperson, CEA, along with Rajesh Kumar Agarwal, Director (Finance), PFC; Piyush Singh, Additional Secretary, Ministry of Power; Diwakar Nath Mishra, Additional Secretary, Ministry of Power; and Dr. D Saibaba, Additional Secretary, Ministry of Power.



Central Bank of India, Zonal Office Chandigarh, in association with Alchemist Hospital, Panchkula, organised a Free Health Check-up Camp at its Zonal Office, Sector 17, Chandigarh. The camp was organised under the guidance of Zonal Head S K Singh in presence of Deputy Zonal Head Priyanka Bansal & Regional Head Ram Kumar Yadav. Dr. Sonia, Dr. Himanshu and the hospital's expert team provided health services to Safai Mitras, general public & bank staff.

BUSINESS OPTIMISM REACHED A FOUR-MONTH PEAK

India's manufacturing sector growth hits seven-month high in September

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 1

India's manufacturing sector activity growth touched a seven-month high in September, boosted by accelerating new orders and output that fuelled solid expansion in factory hiring, a monthly survey reported on Thursday.

Indian manufacturing activity regained its upward momentum in September, driven by strong domestic and export demand. Moreover, business optimism reached a four-month peak.

The seasonally-adjusted HSBC India Manufacturing Purchasing Managers' Index (PMI) rose by more than two index points in September, to 55.1 from 52.8 in August, signalling the strongest improvement in the health of the sector for seven months.

In the Purchasing Managers' Index (PMI), a print above 50 means expansion, while a score below 50 denotes contraction.

"India's factory sector ended the quarter on a firmer footing. The PMI rose to 55.1 in September, up from 52.8, as stronger domestic and overseas demand lifted sales and production. Hiring resumed at its fastest pace since May, and manufacturers became more optimistic about the months ahead," Pranjul Bhandari, Chief India Economist at HSBC, said.

On the price front, there were quicker increases in both input costs and selling prices, but rates of inflation remained mild by historical standards.

Firms also procured more materials for use in production processes and to add to inventories. Overall buying levels expanded at a quicker pace than in August.

"Companies bought more materials and built up stocks to prepare for anticipated sales. Finished goods inventories recorded their second-largest increase in nearly 12 years, signalling a clear shift from leaner stock levels," Bhandari said.

Strong demand across electronics, food, pharma, and textiles pushed total sales growth to its highest level since February.

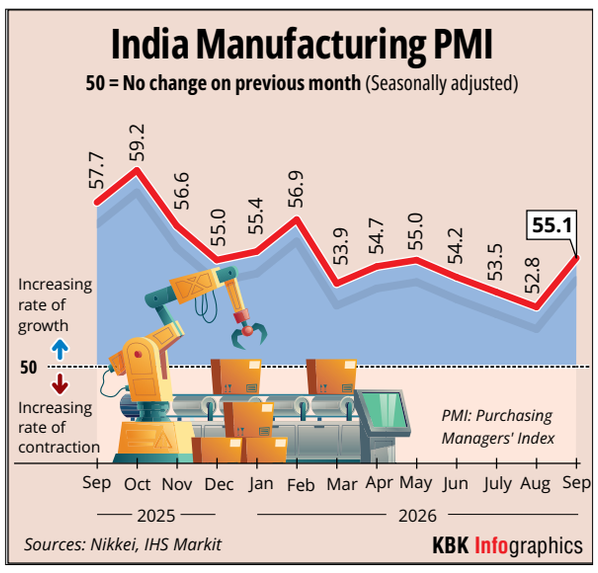
Moreover, export orders also expanded at a quicker pace from clients in Brazil, Europe, the UAE and the US.

According to panellists, job growth resumed in September, following a blip in the previous month and the pace of expansion in employment was solid and the most pronounced since May.

Indian manufacturers upgraded their output forecasts in September, with the overall level of positive sentiment rising to a four-month high. This positive outlook was driven by a healthy pipeline of new inquiries and expectations of sustained strong demand.

Expecting stronger demand ahead, manufacturers actively built up inventory. "Holdings of finished products increased for the third month in a row and at the second-fastest pace in 11-and-a-half years (behind July)," the report said.

The HSBC India Manufacturing PMI is compiled by S&P Global from responses to questionnaires sent to purchasing managers in a panel of around 400 manufacturers.



KEY POINTS

- Indian manufacturing activity regained its upward momentum in September, driven by strong domestic and export demand
- On the price front, there were quicker increases in both input costs and selling prices, but rates of inflation remained mild by historical standards
- Firms also procured more materials for use in production processes and to add to inventories. Overall buying levels expanded at a quicker pace than in August

Markets fall for 4th day, Sensex hits fresh 52-week low amid FII selling

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Mumbai, October 1

Market benchmark indices Sensex and Nifty extended losses for the fourth straight session on Thursday as heavy FII selling, high bond yields and a fresh spike in crude oil prices weighed on investor sentiment.

The BSE Sensex dropped 570.59 points, or 0.79 per cent, to settle at 71,909.70.

The 30-share benchmark shed as much as 1,187.41 points to hit a fresh 52-week low of 71,292.88 during the session. The 50-share NSE Nifty tumbled 198.50 points, or 0.88 per cent, to end at 22,421.95.

From the 30 Sensex firms, Maruti, Mahindra & Mahindra, Tata Steel, Adani Ports, ITC, Power Grid, Hindustan Unilever and Eternal were the major laggards.

Infosys, Tata Consultancy Services, HCL Tech and HDFC Bank were among the winners.

Foreign Institutional Investors (FIIs) offloaded equities worth Rs 10,148.41 crore on Wednesday, according to exchange data.

Brent crude, the global oil benchmark, jumped 2.77 per cent to $100.8 per barrel.

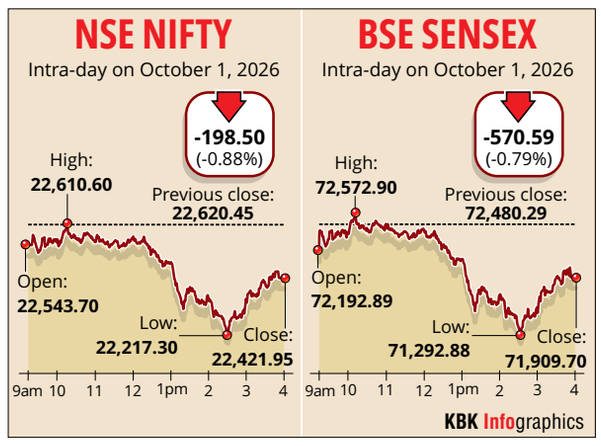
"The market sell-off has been driven largely by external factors, with bond yields reaching multi-year highs and crude oil prices remaining elevated, raising concerns about the economic outlook for 2026-27," Vinod Nair, Head of Research, Geojit Investments Ltd, said.

The BSE SmallCap Select index tanked 0.96 per cent and the MidCap Select index was down 0.71 per cent.

Among the BSE sectoral indices, Auto tumbled 3.09 per cent, Metal 2.18 per cent, Consumer Discretionary 2.07 per cent, Commodities 1.90 per cent, Utilities 1.71 per cent, Housing Finance 1.52 per cent, FMCG 1.51 per cent and Consumer Durables 1.35 per cent. IT, Telecom, Insurance and Hospitals were the winners.

The rupee depreciated by 31 paise to settle at 96.25 against the US dollar, the lowest level in more than two months to below the psychologically important 96 per dollar mark on Thursday,

On the weekly front, the Sensex tanked 1,986.04 points, or 2.68 per cent, and the Nifty plunged 718.55 points, or 3.10 per cent. In September, the BSE benchmark lost 4,476.98 points, or 5.81 per cent, and the Nifty fell 1,459.95 points, or 6 per cent.



THE RUPEE DEPRECIATED BY 31 PAISE TO SETTLE AT 96.25 AGAINST US DOLLAR

NSE gets SEBI's NOC to introduce Corporate Bond Index Futures

MPOST BUREAU
Mumbai, October 1

National Stock Exchange of India Limited (NSE) has received a No Objection Certificate (NOC) from the SEBI for the proposed introduction of futures contracts on a Corporate Bond Index.

The proposed product seeks to provide market participants with an exchange-traded instrument for managing corporate bond market risk and facilitate development of the broader corporate bond derivatives ecosystem in India.

Corporate Bond Index Futures are expected to complement the growing corporate bond market by providing an additional avenue for risk management, portfolio hedging and price discovery. The product can also support the development of market making by enabling participants to manage market risk arising from their corporate bond portfolios.

The introduction of the product is subject to requisite approval from the RBI.

The proposed initiative is aligned with NSE's continued efforts towards deepening India's fixed income markets and expanding the suite of exchange-traded risk-management products available to market participants.

CII welcomes govt's decision to extend RoDTEP till December

MPOST BUREAU
Mumbai, October 1

The Confederation of Indian Industry (CII) welcomed the government's decision to extend the RoDTEP Scheme until December 31, 2026, saying the move would provide timely support to Indian exporters amid an evolving global trade environment.

Sanjay Budhia, Chairman, CII National Committee on Exports, said, "The Indian industry welcomes the Government's decision to extend the RoDTEP Scheme until 31st December 2026. This timely extension provides crucial support to exporters and will help sustain India's export competitiveness amid a challenging and evolving global trade environment. Representing the voice of the industry, CII had recommended continuing the scheme beyond its 30th September 2026 expiration with a longer-term extension of five years. CII looks forward to a longer-term policy horizon for export support. This would guarantee greater certainty, enabling more effective export pricing and the securing of long-term contracts We sincerely appreciate the Government's responsiveness to industry concerns and look forward to continued engagement to strengthen this vital support for India's exporters and foster greater policy stability."



Sanjay Budhia, Chairman, CII National Committee on Exports

CII said it looked forward to continued engagement with the government to build a stable and supportive policy ecosystem for exporters.

PFRDA sets two-year timeline to deploy NPS savings into large-scale infrastructure works

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 1

Subscribers' savings under the National Pension System (NPS) will soon be deployed straight into large-scale infrastructure works, with the pension regulator setting a two-year timeline for permitting such investments, PFRDA Chairperson S Ramann said.

The objective is to commit part of the long-horizon corpus held by retirement savers to assets that take years to mature and generate returns, he indicated.

A committee has been set up by the Pension Fund Regulatory and Development Authority (PFRDA) to study the direct route.

THE OBJECTIVE IS TO COMMIT PART OF LONG-HORIZON CORPUS HELD BY RETIREMENT SAVERS TO ASSETS THAT TAKE YEARS TO MATURE & GENERATE RETURNS, RAMANN INDICATED

This would run parallel to the indirect avenues the regulator already intends to use, namely alternative investment funds, real estate investment trusts and infrastructure investment trusts.

Under a proposed facility called NPS Tatkal, users will be able to open accounts and contribute through their existing bank accounts using UPI.

Small traders, gig and informal workers and those running their own businesses are the intended audience. Common Service Centres will help extend access in underserved areas. Ramann also set a 2047 target for every Jan Dhan account holder to have a linked NPS account.

Last December, PFRDA had eased its investment norms, opening NPS portfolios to a wider set of instruments including gold and silver ETFs, alternative funds and InvITs.

Alongside the investment push, the regulator wants to bring roughly three crore more people into the scheme within two years, with digital enrolment as the main lever, according to Ramann.

Two further products are planned. NPS Sanchay would act as the default plan for subscribers outside government service, while NPS Swasthya pairs a pension account with a family floater top-up health cover, for which operating guidelines came out on September 18.

CORPORATE KALEIDOSCOPE



Marking 88 years of its journey of financial empowerment, J&K Bank on Thursday reaffirmed its commitment to serving the people of J&K and Ladakh. MD & CEO Amitava Chatterjee chaired the commemorative event at the Bank's Regional Business Centre in Jammu in the presence of ED Sudhir Gupta, Chief General Managers, General Managers and Divisional Heads.

Ideas and enterprise can create jobs in India to make it a developed country: Narayana Murthy

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, October 1

Infosys Founder N R Narayana Murthy said India can create jobs through ideas and enterprise to become a developed nation, speaking at O P Jindal Global University's 17th Anniversary and University Day.

He said, "The softest pillow is a clear conscience," and stressed that "it's very simple to do the right thing if you set it as the benchmark." On failure, he said, "Failure is like a series of steps towards success," urging students to learn from mistakes and not be driven into inaction.



Prof. C Raj Kumar, Founding Vice Chancellor, JGU, said institutions endure "when integrity becomes institutional culture, when excellence becomes habit and when leadership becomes responsibility."

Prof. Dabiru Sridhar Patnaik, Registrar, JGU, said Infosys & JGU were built on "values, by long-term purpose rather than short-term gain and by a commitment to excellence that never compromised integrity."

Prof. R Sudarshan, Dean, Jindal School of Government and Public Policy, called Murthy an example of "vision, ideas, innovation and hard work" through ethical leadership.

K. Jairaj, IAS, Former Additional Chief Secretary, Karnataka, highlighted Infosys' technological, entrepreneurial and philanthropic milestones.

Akhilesh Pathak takes charge as Director (Projects), POWERGRID



MPOST BUREAU
Gurugram, October 1

Akhilesh Pathak has assumed the charge as Director (Projects) of Power Grid Corporation of India Ltd (POWERGRID) with effect from September 30, 2026.

An Electrical & Electronics Engineering graduate, Pathak joined POWERGRID as an Executive Trainee in its first batch in 1993 and has over 32 years of power-sector experience.

Pathak played a key role in POWERGRID's highest-ever CAPEX utilisation, asset capitalisation and transmission-line additions.

He also led the Arun-3 SAPDC Transmission Project in Nepal and contributed to expanding consultancy services in domestic and international markets. Before this appointment, he served as Executive Director (Project Management), POWERGRID.

NTPC power generation rises 13% to 118 BU in Q2

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, October 1

NTPC has reported about 12.93 per cent year-on-year growth in power generation to 117.9 billion units (BU) in July-Septemberquarter of current fiscal from 104.4 BU in the year-ago quarter.

"NTPC recorded robust growth across generation, coal dispatch and power trading, reflecting sustained operational efficiency," the company said in a statement on Thursday.

Coal dispatch during Q2 FY 2026-27 stood at 11.899 million metric Tonnes (MMT), compared to 9.260 MMT in Q2 FY 2025-26, marking a significant year-on-year growth of 28.45 per cent, NTPC said.

Its power trading volume also rose 22 per cent to 15.06 BU in Q2 FY2026-27 from 12.34 BU in Q2 FY26.

Under the Ministry of Power, NTPC is India's largest power generation company, catering to the country's one-fourth energy demand alone.

NTPC has an installed capacity of over 91 GW, with another 35 per cent GW under construction.

Mumbai Metro expansion hits airport height hurdle

Issue concerns elevated portion of corridor near Airport Colony station

MPOST BUREAU
Mumbai, October 1

Construction on a section of Mumbai Metro Line 7A, the 3.4-km extension connecting Andheri East with Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj International Airport, has been held up over a height-clearance issue involving the Over-Head Electrification (OHE) system required to operate the line.

The issue concerns the elevated portion of the corridor near the Airport Colony station in Vile Parle East. According to MMRDA officials, the additional height required for the OHE system is around 2.5 metres above the height permitted under the applicable aviation restrictions. The discrepancy was flagged in 2025, after substantial civil work on the affected stretch had already been completed. MMRDA has said the project's General Consultant, the SYSTRA-CEG-SMCIPL consortium, was responsible for coordinating the design and statutory requirements, including aviation-related restrictions. The authority has said the additional height required for the OHE was not adequately factored into the design and planning at the appropriate stage. SYSTRA, however, has maintained that it was not responsible for the issue. The matter is now pending with the Airports Authority of India (AAI), whose final technical assessment on the permissible height is awaited.

MMRDA has said it will undertake a detailed technical review after receiving the report and determine the way forward. The potential consequences could be significant. MMRDA data cited in reports showed that the elevated viaduct in the affected section had been completed & about 95 per cent of the elevated ramp had been constructed by February 2026. If the additional height is not cleared and no technical modification is possible, part of the elevated structure may have to be reconstructed. Line 7A is planned to connect with the underground Metro Line 3 at the airport, providing a direct metro link between the northern suburbs and the airport.

CLOSER LOOK

- Additional height needed for OHE system is around 2.5 metres above permitted height under applicable aviation restrictions
- MMRDA has said it will undertake a detailed technical review after receiving the report and determine the way forward

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Manoj Kumar Rai S/o Sh. Naval Kishore Rai R/o H. No. 429, Gali No.2, Shankar Marg, Mandawali Fazalpur, Shakarpur, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **FIR No. 34/2024 U/S 188 IPC, PS Connaught Place, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest their upon issued that the said accused **Manoj Kumar Rai** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Manoj Kumar Rai** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Manoj Kumar Rai** of **FIR No. 34/2024 U/S 188 IPC, PS Connaught Place, New Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of **16.12.2026.**

By Order,
Ms. Charan Salwan
Judicial Magistrate First Class-01
21, First Floor, Main Building
Patiala House Courts, New Delhi

DP/13905/CD/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPc

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Lokesh @ Haddi S/o Sh. Pinki R/o A-4/153, Nand Nagri, Delhi**, 2nd Add.- **B-289, Gali No.10/2, Meet Nagar, Jyoti Nagar, Delhi-93,** 3rd Add.- **A4/320, Tentwala School, Nand Nagri, Delhi** & 4th Add.- **4/459, Nand Nagri, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **FIR No. 379/2019 U/S 25 Arms Act, PS GTB Enclave, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest their upon issued that the said accused **Lokesh @ Haddi** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Lokesh @ Haddi** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Lokesh @ Haddi** of **FIR No. 379/2019 U/S 25 Arms Act, PS GTB Enclave, Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of **05.11.2026.**

By Order,
Ms. Sanghamitra
Judicial Magistrate First Class-01
Room No. 54, Second Floor, Shahdara District
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/13824/SHD/2026(Court Matter)

DELHI TRANSCO LIMITED

EXPRESSION OF INTEREST (EOI)

DTL intends to invite following Expression Of Interest (EOI)

Inviting stakeholder inputs and feedback to validate and strengthen the bidding process for establishing public EV charging and battery swapping infrastructure under the Delhi EV Policy, 2026.

For complete details of EOI please visit website: -**https://dtl.gov.in.**

Inputs may be submitted within **07 days** of this publishing through:

https://docs.google.com/forms/d/e/1FAIpQLSdWsQD5i3Kh3fUL4idBISyNy4Yo3j9-eNIlWusz2ZIQJjfPg/viewform?pli=1&pli=1

Any stakeholder / individuals willing to offer land parcels, parking areas or premises for the establishment of EV charging or battery swapping stations may furnish site details via: **https://docs.google.com/forms/d/e/1FAIpQLSddpitB_62KBFaJh8jZpY9fOx8sBepLCH8Y7euKB_DiP4rFAw/viewform?usp=preview.**

CENTRAL RAILWAY

NAGPUR DIVISION

E-TENDER NOTICE

E-TENDER NOTICE No. NGP-TDC-ELECT-2026-27-02R Date: 23/09/2026 E- Open Tender is invited: Description: "Provision of Wall mounted Industrial type Air Conditioner Unit in S&T installations work at various New EI installation buildings in connection with NGP-SEGM 3rd & 4th line and WR(SEGM)-BPQ 3rd Line of Nagpur division Central Railway" **Estimated Cost of the work:** ₹. 2,51,41,190.85/-, **Cost of Tender Form:** NIL., **Address of Office:** Office of the Deputy Chief Electrical Engineer (Construction), 3rd Floor, DRM's Building. Kingsway, Central Railway, NAGPUR - 440001., **Earnest Money Deposit:** ₹. 5,02,800.00/-, **Completion Period:** 09 Months, **Closing of Tender:** On 22/10/2026 15:00 Hrs, **Date and Time of Opening of Tender:** On 22/10/2026 15:30 Hrs., **Web Address:** For details of Tender notice visit: **www.ireps.gov.in**

Deputy Chief Electrical Engineer (Construction)
446 Nagpur

Traveling with dangerous and explosive goods is a punishable offense

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY

Open E-Tender Notice

No.- MC/Wheel press/AMC/02/26
Date: 29.09.2026

Sr. DME/ECR/DDU on behalf of the President of India invite "Open" 'E-Tender' on Single Packet System from the eligible and experienced agency or contractor for e-tender no. MC-Wheel press-AMC-02-26. Particular are as under:-

Name of the work with its location : "Comprehensive AMC of Hydraulic Wheel Press 500T machine, S.O. No. 11000363 installed at Machine Shed, WCC/DDU". **Approx. cost of the work:** Rs. 73,98,330.00/- (Seventy three Lakh ninety eight thousand three hundred thirty only.), **Earnest Money to be deposited :** (Rs. 1,48,000.00/-) One lakh forty eighty thousand only.), **Date & Time for submission of tender and opening of Tender :** From 07.10.2026 up to closing of tender at 15:00 hrs. on 21.10.2026., **Website particulars, Notice Board location where complete details of tender can be seen and address of the office from where the tender form can be purchased etc.:** IREPS Website:- www.ireps.gov.in Bidders will be able to submit their original/revised bids online through this website only. Manual offer are not allowed against this tender and any such manual offer received shall be ignored.

Note:- Detail information may be seen in the tender documents.

Sr. DME (C&W)/E.C.Rly./DDU
PR/1038/DDU/C&W/T/26-27/40

UJVN Ltd.

(An Uttarakhand Govt. Enterprises)
H.O. "UJJWAL" Maharani Bagh, GMS Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephone-0135-2763808 Fax: 0135-2763508
CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866 Website: www.ujvnl.com

RO No. 895 **Date: 01.10.2026**

Short Term E-Tender Notice

Office of the Executive Engineer, (M&G) Pathri Power House, Bahadrabad, Haridwar invites online bids from interested parties. Brief summary of tender is given below:-

1. Tender No.: 24/EE(Pathri)/2026-27 – Hiring of one no. Non-AC diesel driven vehicle for use of Executive Engineer (M&G), Pathri and one no. Driver for running of Departmental ambulance for a period of one year.

2. Tender No.: 25/EE(Pathri)/2026-27–Supply of various types of spares for 66KV Switchyard & 12 MVA Transformer of Pathri Power House.

Estimated Cost: Rs. 7,34,100.00 + GST extra & Rs. 13,11,000.00 + GST extra respectively.

Date of availability of bid document on portal: 03-10-2026, at 16:00 Hrs.

Last date for submission of tender on portal: 16-10-2026, up to 16:00 Hrs.

For fuller & further details, kindly visit e-procurement portal **"https://uktenders.gov.in"**

EXECUTIVE ENGINEER (M&G)

"AVOID WASTEFUL USE OF ELECTRICITY"

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C./84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita

Whereas a complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Akhtar Mohd. Shinwari S/o** Khataan C/o Bharat Bhushan **R/o** 21/132, Block-B, Veena Enclave, Ratna Park, Nangloi, West Delhi have committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence under **FIR No.117/2019 Dt. 18.07.2019 U/s 21/29/61/85 NDPS Act**., has been registered at **PS: Special Cell, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said, **Akhtar Mohd. Shinwari** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said, **Akhtar Mohd. Shinwari** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused, **Akhtar Mohd. Shinwari** of under **FIR No.117/2019 Dt. 18.07.2019 U/s 21/29/61/85 NDPS Act**., Registered at **PS: Special Cell, New Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **04.11.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Anuradha Shukla
Special Judge, NDPS-09
Rouse Avenue Court, New Delhi

DP/13159/SP. CELL/2026 (Court Notice)

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

Letter No:- DRM/C/AGRA/Parcel/E-AUCTION **Dated : 30.09.2026**

E-Auction Notice

On Behalf of the President of India, The Sr. Divisional Commercial Manager-North Central Railway-Agra invites E-Auction as per categories given as under:-

Category : Parcel	Auction Catalogue No. : AGRA-LEASING-52

Asset Details : **1.** 01 (F1) SLR Unit in Train no. 14854
2. 01 (R1) SLR Unit in Train no. 20178
3. 01 (R1) SLR Unit in Train no. 12195
4. 01 (F1) SLR Unit in Train no. 12180

E-Auction Start Date and Time : Date:- 15.10.2026, Time :- 12:00

E-Auction End Date and Time : Date:- 15.10.2026, Time :- 13:10

Note :- Prospective bidders are requested to visit E-Auction Leasing Module on IREPS website **(www.ireps.gov.in).** The Lot-wise details are available therein under the above mentioned Catalogue Number. **2232/26 (C)**

North central railways | www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in | @ CPRONC

UJVN Limited

(An Uttarakhand Govt. Enterprises)
H.O.: "UJJWAL', Maharani Bagh, GMS Road, Dehradun-248006
(Telephones: 0135-2763508, 2763808 & Fax- 0135- 2763507
CIN No U40101UR2001SGC025866, Website: www.ujvnl.com

पत्र संः 898 दिनांकः 01/10/2026

e-Tender Notice

Office of The Executive Engineer (Civil-I), Lakhwar Multipurpose Project, Dakpathar (Distt-Dehradun) invites sealed and separate tenders from interested parties. Brief summary of tenders are given below:

Tender No.- 05/EE(Civil-I)/LMP/2026-27
Name of work- Repair and maintenance of residences of Lakhwar project at Dakpathar (Dehradun).
Estimated Cost- Rs. 65,22,287.00 (Excluding GST)
Date & Time of availability of bid document on website- 01.10.2026, from 17:00 Hrs.
Last Date for submission of tender on website - 24.10.2026, up to 17:00 Hrs.
For fuller & further details, kindly visit e-procurement portal **"http://uktenders.gov.in"**

Executive Engineer (Civil-I)

"Avoid wasteful use of Electricity"

OFFICE OF THE CHIEF ENGINEER (CIVIL) AU & PC, CSPGCL,

Shed No. 2, Dangania, Raipur-492013 Phone No. 0771-2576320 & 0771-2576324, website :www.cspc.co.in E-mail:- cecivil.aupc@gmail.com

No.03-15/W/ 57488 **Raipur, date 30.09.2026**

E-TENDER NOTICE

Online bids are invited through CSPCL e-bidding system (SAP SRM) from eligible bidders fulfilling the eligibility criteria as mentioned below and having experience in Govt./Public Sector Undertaking/Local bodies/Power Generating Companies in India only for the following work :-

Sl. No	Tender Specification No.	Description	NIT value i/c GST (Rs.)	EMD (Rs.)	Completion period (incl. Rainy season)	Rfx No.
1	CEC/AU&PC/ HTPS-KW/W/ 2026/45	Construction of Cement Concrete Road over starter dyke and ramps of lagoon-1A for ash transportation work from Jhabu Ash Dyke HTPS, CSPGCL, Korba West.	132.00 Lacs	1,32,000/-	03 Months	81000 54507

(i)Cost of tender form is Rs. 1180/- (Rs.1000/- + 18% GST). (ii) The due date & time for submission of bids, Tender Cost & EMD is 23.10.2026 (up to 15:00 Hrs) and bid opening date (Techno commercial bids) is 26.102026 (at 16:00 Hrs) respectively. (iii)The tender document can be viewed and downloaded online from our e-bidding portal https://ebidding.cspcl.co.in: 50724/irj/portal. Note:- (a) The L-1 bidder shall be decided on overall cost to company basis including GST. (b) In case, the rate quoted by the bidder is on abnormally lower side, a performance guarantee @5% of contract value i/c GST in addition to Security Deposit shall have to be deposited by the bidder. (c) Maintenance period for the work shall be 12 Months. (d) Subletting of contract will not be allowed.

Chief Engineer (Civil) AU & PC,
CSPGCL, Raipur

//Save Electricity// samvad 49262/1

Muthoot Homefin (India) Ltd.

Corporate Office: Unit No. 19-NE, 19th Floor, The Ruby, Senapati Bapat Marg, Near Ruparel College, Dadar (West), Mumbai, Maharashtra - 400 028

DEMAND NOTICE

Under Section 13(2) of the Securitisation And Reconstruction of Financial Assets And Enforcement Of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with Rule 3 (1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002.

The undersigned is the Authorised Officer of Muthoot Homefin (India) Ltd. (MHIL) under Securitisation And Reconstruction Of Financial Assets And Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 (the said Act). In exercise of powers conferred under Section 13(2) of the said Act read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002, the Authorised Officer has issued Demand Notices under section 13(2) of the said Act, calling upon the following Borrower/s (the "said Borrower"), to repay the amounts mentioned in the respective Demand Notice/s issued to them that are also given below.

In connection with above, Notice is hereby given, once again, to the said Borrower to pay to MHIL, within 60 days from the publication of this Notice, the amounts indicated herein below, together with further interest at 2% p.m. as detailed in the said Demand Notices, from the dates mentioned below till the date of payment and/or realization, payable under the loan agreement read with other documents/writings, if any, executed by the said Borrowers. As security for due repayment of the loan, the following assets have been mortgaged to MHIL by the said Borrowers respectively.

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower(s)/ Co-Borrower(s)/ Guarantor/ Loan Account No./Branch	Total Outstanding Dues (Rs.)	Date of Demand Notice	Description of secured asset (immovable property)
1.	Vajid/ Asgar Ali/ Jarina Khatun/ DEL-NHL-000624/ Delhi	Rs. 14,95,788/- Rupees Fourteen Lakh Ninety Five Thousand Seven Hundred Eighty Eight Only.	01-Sep-2026	Situated At Freehold Residential House No. 406, Khasra No. 296, Area Measuring 126.80 Sq.mtr Situated At Abadi Village Saroorpur Kalan Tehsil And Distt. Bhagpat, U.P. Pin 250619 In Respect of Said Property Boundaries As North Ne-road 20 Ft, South Sw - Kailash House Se Ali Hasan East Sw- Kailash House, West Nw - 25 Ft

If the said Borrowers shall fail to make payment to MHIL as aforesaid, MHIL shall proceed against the above secured assets under Section 13(4) of the Act and the applicable Rules, entirely at the risks of the said Borrowers as to the costs and consequences.

The said Borrowers are prohibited under the Act from transferring the aforesaid assets, whether by way of sale, lease or otherwise without the prior written consent of MHIL. Any person who contravenes or abets contravention of the provisions of the said Act or Rules made thereunder, shall be liable for imprisonment and/or penalty as provided under the Act.

Date: October 02, 2026
Place: Bhagpat

Sd/-Authorized Officer,
Muthoot Homefin (India) Limited

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Persons namely **Sovran Singh Dhakad** S/o: Devi Lal Dhakad, R/o: H. No. B-90, Mangla Puri, Palam Phase-2, Palam Village South West Delhi, Sagarpur, Delhi (or is suspected to has committed) the offence in **FIR 225/2023, U/s: 12/9/55 Gambling Act,** Date : 18.04.2023, registered at P.S.: Sagarpur, Delhi and the warrant has been returned writing upon that the said accused **Sovran Singh Dhakad** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Sovran Singh Dhakad** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Sovran Singh Dhakad** accused **FIR, 225/2023, U/s: 12/9/55 Gambling Act,** registered at P.S.: Sagarpur, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **04.11.2026.**

By Order
Sh. Aridaman Singh Cheema,LD.
Judical Magistrate First Class-03
Room No. 28, First Floor, Main Building,
Patiala House Courts, Delhi

DP/13985/SW/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr.PC)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Sonu, S/o Pratap R/o Noida Road, Delhi East** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.285/2018 u/s 356/379/34 IPC, P.S. Mandawali, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Sonu** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Sonu** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Sonu** of **FIR No.285/2018 u/s 356/379/34 IPC, P.S. Mandawali, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **19.11.2026.**

By Order,
Sh. Sachin
Judicial Magistrate First Class, East District
Court No.16, Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/13700/ED/2026

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Tender Notice No. JHS-N-W-73-26 **Date: 28.09.2026**

E-Tendering Tender Notice

Sr. Divisional Signal & Telecommunication Engineer/Jhansi, DRM's office, Jhansi, for and on behalf of President of India invite open Tender through on Line **(E-Tendering)** for the following works.

E-Tender No.: JHS-N-W-73–26	Approx Cost : Rs. 6454361.28

Description of work : Provision of S&T work in connection with Shifting of OHE depot and Tower Wagon siding from DHO to MRA for better mobility of Tower wagon/staff.

Earnest Money : Rs. 129100/-	Cost of Tender form : Nil

Opening of tender : 23.10.2026 Time **15:00**

Completion period from issue of letter of acceptance : 12 Months

• Tender on line can be submitted upto **15:00** hrs on **23.10.2026.** • For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website **www.ireps.gov.in.**
(NORTH CENTRAL RLY/JHANSI DIVISION-S AND T) **2217/26 (D)**

North central railways | @ CPRONCR | www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 (2) (i) Cr. P.C./84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita

Whereas a complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Adnan S/o** Sarif Ahmad **R/o** H.No. 3329, Gali Bagichi Achheji, Azad Market, Bara Hindu Rao, Delhi, has committed (or is suspected to has committed) the offence under **Case/FIR No. 501/2022 U/s 33 Delhi Ex. Act**., has been registered at **PS: Subzi Mandi, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said, **Adnan** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said, **Adnan** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused, **Adnan** of under **Case/FIR No. 501/2022 U/s 33 Delhi Ex. Act**., Registred at: **PS: Subzi Mandi, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **03.11.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Preeti Rajoria
JMFC-07, Room No. 32
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/13981/N/2026 (Court Notice)

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

T. Notice No. 230-Elect/TRD/PRYJ/E-Tender Notice/2026/666 **Date: 29.09.2026**

E-Tender Notice

Sr. Divl. Electrical Engineer/TRD/N.C.Rly/Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invite the following E-Tender, the details of the tenders are as under:-

T. No.: 230-TRD-WC-1055-2026	Completion Period: 12 Months

Description of work: 25kV OHE modification work due to Extension of platform No. 1 at Aligarh station of Prayagraj Division.

Advertised value: ₹ 53,93,353.67	Bid Security: ₹ 1,07,900.00
Bidding system: Single Packet	Tender Closing date & Time: 21.10.2026 & 14:00 Hrs
Tender Opening date & Time: 21.10.2026 & 15:00 Hrs	

Note:- 1. The complete information along with tender document of above E-Tenders shall be available on Website **www.ireps.gov.in** 21days prior to the date of opening of the tender. **2.** Bids other than in the form of E-Bids shall not be accepted against above tenders. For this purpose, vendors are required to get themselves registered with IREPS website along with Digital Signature Certificate. **3.** In case of any difficulty helpdesk available on the website of IREPS may be approached. **2230/26(AK)**

North central railways | @CPRONCR | www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Tender No. : GSU-ST-JWK-KWW-9-2026 **Date : 28.09.2026**

E-Tender Notice

Dy. CSTE Gati Shakti Unit (Signal & telecommunication), N. C. Railway PRYJ for and on behalf of the President of India invites open E-tender on prescribed form for the following work up to **12.00** hrs on the opening date of E-tender mentioned therein. The details of the Tender are as under:-

S.N.1.	Tender No. : 9	Approx. Cost of work (Rs.) : 147751864.08

Name of work : Provision of new electronic interlocking in connection with conversion of 'D' class Jawaharpur Kamsan station and Kuswa station into 'B' class station station along with 2 common loops in BRN-ETAH section of Prayagraj Division.

Earnest Money (Rs.) : 2955000.00	Cost of Tender Form : 0.00
Completion Period : 24 Months	Date of Opening of tender : 21.10.2026

2. Availability of tender form : Tender forms are available on **www.ireps.gov.in**

3. Earnest Money to be deposited : The prescribed amount of Earnest Money as mentioned above must be deposited along with the tender form Online through Internet Banking or Online Payment gateway only. The tenders should note that, in any case, the Earnest Money in any other form than specified above shall not be acceptable. Tenders without earnest money shall be summarily rejected.

4. Time & Place of opening of tender : Tender will be opened through E-tender at office of Divisional Railway Manager, Prayagraj at or after **12:30** hours. In Case tender opening date happens to be holiday, Tenders will be opened on the next working day.

5. Validity of offer : 60 days from the date of opening.

6. Right of Railway to deal with tender : Railway administration reserves the rights to postpone / modify or to cancel the tender without assigning any reasons. **2218/26 (PH)**

North central railways | @CPRONCR | www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

Tender Notice No.: Dy. CPM-GSU-20 **Date:** 29.09.2026

E-TENDER NOTICE

Dy. Chief Project Manager/Gati Shakti Unit /Prayagraj, North Central Railway, acting for and on behalf of the President of India, invites E-tender for the following work through Open Tender–Two Packet System :-

Tender No.: GSU-20	Approx. cost of work (Rs.): ₹ 304399656.12

Name of Work: Conversion of 'D' Class Kushwa & Jawaharpur Kamsun Station into 'B' Class Station in Barhan-Etah Section in Prayagraj Division of North Central Railway.

Earnest Money (Rs.): ₹ 6088000.00	Completion Period: 12 Months

Date of Opening of Tender: 21.10.2026 15:30 hrs.

Similar Work for Eligibility Criteria: For Civil work : Any Civil engineering work. **For Electrical work:** Satisfactory execution of any electrical work related to HT/T/LT installation.

Note :- (1) Tender on line can be submitted up to **15:30 hrs.** on **21.10.2026. (2)** The complete information along with tender document of above E-tender are available on Website **www.ireps.gov.in** up to **15:30 hrs.** on the due date of tender opening i.e. **21.10.2026.** **2236/26 (A)**

North central railways | @CPRONCR | www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C / 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Dashrath @ Raj Yadav, S/o.: Sh. Bharat Yadav, R/o.: H. No. 244, Gali No.17, Block-B, Khajuri Khas, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in a case vide **FIR No.31/2012 U/S 33(1A) Delhi Excise Act** registered at **P.S Alipur, Outer North District, Delhi** and it has been returned on a warrant of arrest there upon issued stating that the said accused **Dashrath @ Raj Yadav** could not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that accused **Dashrath @ Raj Yadav** is absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Dashrath @ Raj Yadav**, accused of **FIR No. 31/2012 U/S 33(1A) Delhi Excise Act, P.S Alipur, Outer North District, Delhi** are required to appear before the court to answer the said complaint on or before **02.11.2026.**

By Order, Ms. Priyanka Rajpoot
Chief Judicial Magistrate/North,
Court No.115, Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/ 13994/ON/2026 (Court Matter)

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

T. Notice No. 230-Elect/TRD/PRYJ/E-Tender Notice/2026/667 **Date : 29.09.2026**

E-Tender Notice

Sr. Divl. Electrical Engineer/TRD/N. C. Rly/Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invites the following E-Tender, the details of the tenders are as under :–

T. No. : 230-TRD-WC-1056-2026	Advertised Value : Rs. 80,84,490.00

Description of work : Replacement of overaged/weak Catenary wire in Pt. Deen Dayal Upadhyaya Junction to Jhinjhak section of Prayagraj Division (3rd Call).

Bid Security : Rs. 1,61,700.00	Completion Period : 12 Months
Bidding system : Single Packet	
Tender Closing date & Time : 21.10.2026 & 14:00 Hrs	
Tender opening date & Time : 21.10.2026 & 15:00 Hrs	

Note :- 1. The complete information along with tender document of above E-Tenders shall be available on Website **www.ireps.gov.in** 21 days prior to the date of opening of the tender. **2.** Bids other than in the form of E-Bids shall not be accepted against above tenders. For this purpose, vendors are required to get themselves registered with IREPS website along with Digital Signature Certificate. **3.** In case of any difficulty helpdesk available on the website of IREPS may be approached. **2231/26 (AS)**

North central railways | www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in | @ CPRONCR

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Tender Notice No. : JHS-N-W-70-26 **Date : 28.09.2026**

E-Tendering Notice

Sr. Divisional Signal & Telecommunication Engineer / Jhansi, DRM's office, Jhansi, for and on behalf of President of India invite open Tender through on Line **(E-Tendering)** for the following works.

E-Tender No. : JHS-N-W-70-26	Earnest Money : Rs. 280200/-

Description of work : Provision of S&T work in connection with - Construction of Track machine stabling siding in Gwalior-Dholpur & Birlanagar-Etawah sections of Jhansi Division.

Approx Cost : Rs. 14009618.95	Cost of Tender Form : Nil.
Opening of tender : 23.10.2026, Time 15:00	
Completion period from issue of letter of acceptance : 12 Months	

• Tender on line can be submitted upto **15:00** hrs on **23.10.2026.** • For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website **www.ireps.gov.in**
(NORTH CENTRAL RLY / JHANSI DIVISION-S AND T) **2215/26 (AS)**

North central railways | www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in | @ CPRONCR

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(SEE SECTION 82(2) (ii) Cr.P.C/ 84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) **GURONKAR S/o Sarabjeet Singh Gill R/o H.No. 1112, Type-2, DDA Flats, Gulabi Bagh, Delhi** has committed (or are suspected to have committed) the offence in case FIR No. **205/2016 U/s 279/304A IPC, PS Sarai Rohilla, Distt. North, Delhi** and it has been returned to a Warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **GURONKAR** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **GURONKAR** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation are hereby made that the said accused person(s) **GURONKAR** of FIR No. **205/2016 U/s 279/304A IPC, PS Sarai Rohilla, Distt. North, Delhi** are required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before dated **03.11.2026 at 10:00 AM.**

By Order
Mr. Ankit Solanki
Judicial Magistrate, First Class-04
North Distt., Room No. 37
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/13935/N/2026 (Court Matter)

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

T. Notice No. 230-Elect/TRD/PRYJ/E-Tender Notice/2026/663 **Date : 29.09.2026**

E- Tender Notice

Sr. Divl. Electrical Engineer/TRD/N. C. Rly/Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invite the following E-Tender, the details of the tenders are as under: -

Tender No.: 230-TRD-WC-1052-2026, Description of work: 25kV OHE modification work due to replacement of old FOB by new FOB at Chola (CHL) & Wair (WIR) stations of Prayagraj Division.	
Advertised Value : ₹ 1,09,70,480.38	Bid Security : 2,19,400.00
Completion Period : 12 Months	Bidding System : Single Packet
Tender Closing Date & Time : 21.10.2026 & 14:00 Hrs.	
Tender Opening Date & Time : 21.10.2026 & 15:00 Hrs.	

Note: - (1) The complete information along with tender document of above E-Tenders shall be available on Website **www.ireps.gov.in** 21days prior to the date of opening of the tender. **(2)** Bids other than in the form of E-Bids shall not be accepted against above tenders. For this purpose, vendors are required to get themselves registered with **IREPS** website along with Digital Signature Certificate. **(3)** In case of any difficulty helpdesk available on the website of **IREPS** may be approached. **2229/26 (MG)**

North central railways | @CPRONCR | www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

Tender Notice No.: GEM/2026/B/8091782 **Date:** 29.09.2026

E-TENDER NOTICE

Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer (General) North Central Railway, Agra for and behalf of President of India invites "Open Tender" through on line only (GeM website) for the following works.

Tender No.: GEM/2026/B/8091782	

Name of work with its location & Completion Period: Agra Division Maintenance and equipment cleaning work of upper and under frame electrical equipment of Non AC TL coaches over Agra division for 02 years.

Approx. Cost of the work: ₹ 8216634.42 (including GST)	Completion period: 24 months

For full details and submission of bid please see the GeM official website Tenders can only be submitted through GeM web portal up to **15:00 hrs.** on **22.10.2026.** **2228/26 (A)**

North central railways | @CPRONCR | www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

KIND ATTENTION RAIL PASSENGERS!

IMPORTANT INFORMATION

RUN OF FESTIVAL SPECIAL TRAIN

In order to clear extra rush of passengers during this festival season, Northern Railway has decided to run the following additional Special Train as per details given below:

04081/04082 NEW DELHI-SHRI MATA VAISHNO DEVI KATRA-NEW DELHI FESTIVAL SPECIAL EXPRESS | 6 Trips

Train No. 04081		STATIONS	Train No. 04082	
ARR.	DEP.		ARR.	DEP.
----	**23:45**	**New Delhi**	**10:00**	----
00:58	01:00	Panipat	07:25	07:27
01:50	01:52	Kurukshetra Jn.	06:25	06:27
02:30	02:40	Ambala Cantt.	05:40	05:50
04:15	04:20	Ludhiana Jn.	03:45	03:50
05:22	05:27	Jalandhar Cantt.	02:45	02:50
07:15	07:20	Pathankot Cantt.	00:45	00:50
09:15	09:25	Jammu Tawi	23:00	23:05
11:08	11:10	Martyr Captain Tushar Mahajan	21:28	21:30
12:00	----	**Shri Mata Vaishno Devi Katra**	----	**21:00**

Days of run :- 04081 Ex. **New Delhi** on 02.10.2026, 03.10.2026 & 04.10.2026 (Friday, Saturday & Sunday) and **04082** Ex. **Shri Mata Vaishno Devi Katra** on 03.10.2026, 04.10.2026 & 05.10.2026 (Saturday, Sunday & Monday).

Composition : 3 Tier AC, Sleeper and General.

For detailed information, please call RailMadad Helpline No. 139 or visit enquiry website: www.enquiry.indianrail.gov.in

RailMadad Helpline No. 139 | Visit RailMadad website:- www.railmadad.indianrailways.gov.in | Download RailMadad app.

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3427/26

Serving Customers with a Smile

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-TENDER NOTICE

The Senior Divisional Electrical Engineer (G), East Central Railway, Samastipur for and on behalf of the **President of Union of India** invites Tender from competent and experienced Contractors having valid Electrical Contractor's license technical expertise, financial solvency through **E-Tendering mode of IREPS web portal of Indian Railway** for execution of the following works. **Tender No. & Date - EL-G-AC-TL- 1-2026-27-RT Dt.-28.09.2026, Sr. No. (1) Name of work with its location -** Corrective maintenance/ Repairing of pantry electrical equipment of LHB RAKES & Saloon (Inspection Carriage over SPJ division for 03 years. **(2) Advertised Value -** Rs. 1,06,69,524.39 (Rupees one crore six lakh sixty nine thousand five hundred twenty four and thirty nine paisa only) **(3) Earnest money/Bid Security -** Rs. 2,13,400/- Cost of tender document - 0 (Nil) **(4) Validity of Offer (Days) -** 90 days **(5) Date & Time for closing & Opening of tender -** Date of Closing of E-Tender at 12.00 hours on 21.10.2026. Date of Closing of E-Tender at 12.30 hours on 21.10.2026. **(6) Website particulars, Notice Board location where complete details of tender can be seen and address of the office : Website - www.ireps.gov.in,** D.R.M. (Elect.) Office/Samastipur. **NOTE :** Any other modification/information related to the above said tender will be uploaded on the website instead of publish in newspaper.

Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer (G)/ Samastipur

PR/1042/SPJ/ELECT/T/26-27/48

कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय

ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमंडल, साहेबगंज

शुद्धि-पत्र

इस कार्यालय के द्वारा आमंत्रित ई0 निविदा संख्या RDD/SD/SAHIBGANJ /04/2026-27, (जिसका P.R. No. 389260 (District) (26-27)D) की तिथियों को अपरिहार्य कारणवश निम्नवत् संशोधित की जाती है :–

क्र0		पूर्व में प्रकाशित तिथि एवं समय	संशोधित तिथि एवं समय
01	वेबसाईट पर निविदा प्रकाशन की तिथि : दिनांक 10.09.2026	दिनांक 10.09.2026	दिनांक 06.10.2026
02	ई–निविदा प्राप्ति की तिथि एवं समय	दिनांक 10.09.2026 से दिनांक 30.09.2026	दिनांक 06.10.026 से दिनांक 27.10.2026
03	ई–निविदा खोलने की तिथि एवं समय –	03.10.2026 अपराह्न 2:00 बजे	29.10.2026 अपराह्न 2:00 बजे

शेष सभी शर्ते यथावत् रहेंगी।

कार्यपालक अभियंता
ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमंडल, साहेबगंज

PR 390923 Rural Development (26-27)_D

झारखण्ड शिक्षा परियोजना परिषद्,

An ISO 9001:2015 certified

जे.एस.सी.ए. स्टेडियम रोड,सेक्टर–3,धुर्वा,राँची–834004
दूरभाष .0651.2444501,2444502,फैक्स–2444506
ई–मेलः jepcranchi1@gmail.com

Notice for Employment

Recruitment of School Manager for the CM School of Excellence and State PMU-Program Specialist (Consultant-Digital Education) & Program Specialist (Consultant Monitoring, Evaluation & Knowledge Management) under Adarsh Vidyalaya Yojna

1. Please refer to the recruitment notice no. ME/01/1198/2023/3871 (for the post of School Manager for the School of Excellence dated: 30.09.2026 and ME/01/1198/2023/3879 (For the post of State PMU-Program Specialist (Consultant-Digital Educaton) & Program Specialist (Consultant Monitoring, Evaluation & Knowledge Management) dated: 30.09.2026 under Adarsh Vidyalaya Yojna.
2. The applicants have been provided option of applying by both offline and online mode. For candidates applying by offline mode as per prescribed application format is available in JEPC website as Annexure.
3. The last date for applying for the post of School Manager for the School of Excellence and State PMU-Program Specialist (Consultant-Digital Educaton) & Program Specialist (Consultant Monitoring, Evaluation & Knowledge Management) shall be till 21.10.2026 up to 05:00 P.M. The application received after the last date shall be rejected
4. For any queries, please contact Toll Free No. 0651-2444501

Memo No. ME/01/1195/2023/3892 Date: 30.09.2026

(Shashi Ranjan)
State Project Director
Jharkhand Education Project Council

PR 390967 Jharkhand Education Project Council(26-27).D

JAMMU AND KASHMIR POLICE
DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS JAMMU
0191-2561578 (O), 0191-254780 (F),
email-sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in
Hue and Cry Notice
Rule No. 712/191

Dy. SP HQ, Jammu has intimated that accused person namely Kuldeep Singh S/O Rashpaul Singh R/O Sayal Sui Tehsil Kalakot Rajouri is evading his arrest/wanted in case FIR No. 138/2011 U/S 379 RPC, of P/S Nowabad, Jammu, since the commission of crime. Despite repeated raids/efforts the accused could not be traced/still absconded.

It is therefore requested that Hue and Cry Notice of above mentioned accused is being published for the information of Police establishments / Public in general having any clue related to the whereabouts / present location of above named accused, kindly communicate the same on the below mentioned contact / Telephone numbers.

Description Roll :-

Name	:	**Kuldeep Singh**
S/O	:	**Rashpaul Singh**
Address	:	**Sayal Sui Tehsil Kalakot Rajouri**

Contacts/Telephone Numbers:-

1.DPO, Jammu	:0191-2547807, 0191-2561578
2. SSP Jammu Mail I.D	: sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in
3.PCR Jammu	:0191-2605949
4.SP City South	: 0191-2433778
5.Dy. SP Hqrs.	: 0191-2562259
6.SHO P/S Nowabad	: 0191-2565274

Sd/-
Sr. Superintendent of Police
Jammu

DIP No:DIP/J-11549/26

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Tender No.- GSU-ST-SKB-7-2026 **Date: 29.09.2026**

E-Tender Notice

Dy.CSTE Gati Shakti Unit (Signal & telecommunication), N. C. Railway PRYJ for and on behalf of the President of India invites open E-tender on prescribed form for the following work up to 12.00 hrs on the opening date of E-tender mentioned there in. **The details of the Tender are as under:-**

SN 1.	**Tender No.:** 7	**Approx Cost of work:** ₹ 29279762.94
Name of work: Modification/alteration in existing EI and associated S&T work in connection due to extension of existing goods line (GT-2) to full length at Shikohabad in Prayagraj Division.		
Earnest Money: ₹ 585600.00		**Cost of Tender Form:** 0.00
Completion Period: 12 Months		**Date of closing of tender:** 23.10.2026

2. Availability of tender form: Tender forms shall be available on **www.ireps.gov.in 3. Time date & place of opening of tender:** Tender will be opened through E-tender at office of Divisional Railway Manager, Prayagraj on or after pre determined date at **12.30** hours. **2238/26(AK)**

North central railways | @CPRONCR | www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

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NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Tendering Notice No. 2026-Sept-03 **Dated : 01.10.26**

E-Tender Notice

Divisional Railway Manager (Engineering), N.C. Rly Agra for and on behalf of the President of India invites "Open Tender" through on Line only (E-Tendering) for the following works. The details of the tender are as under :

Tender No.: 2026-Sept-03-01	**Approx Cost Rs. :** 13366242.75
Description of Work : Maintenance, Cleanliness and repair to existing nurseries and green patches at various stations in the jurisdiction of ADEN/HQ/Agra and ADEN-Line/IDH for 24 months.	
Tender No.: 2026-Sept-03-02	**Approx Cost Rs. :** 19806156.56
Description of Work : Composite work (Civil+Electrical) for Augmentation / Upgradation of facilities in existing Running Rooms & lobbies of Agra Division.	
Tender No.: 2026-Sept-03-03	**Approx Cost Rs. :** 141519930.68
Description of Work : Provision of Precast RCC boundary wall between Billochpura- BAD (Ex) section." (12 Running Km).	
Tender No.: 2026-Sept-03-04	**Approx Cost Rs. :** 9161316.15
Description of Work : Provision of Rainwater Harvesting in Service buildings at Agra Cantt, Agra Fort and Raja ki Mandi stations.	
Tender No.: 2026-Sept-03-05	**Approx Cost Rs. :** 11065176.61
Description of Work : Through Turn out Renewal 57 Nos in AGC-BFP section.	

• For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website **"www.ireps.gov.in"** • Tenders can only be submitted through web portal **"www.ireps.gov.in"** up to **15.00 hrs on 22.10.26** **2248/26 (AS)**

North central railways | www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in | @ CPRONCR

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

Latter No. 136-E/Dy.CPO/C/Re-engagement/Group-C/Pt-II **Date : 23.09.2026**

Notification

Option is hereby called from willing retired SSE/P.Way for re-engagement in exigencies of services in Construction Organization of N.C. Railway with following terms & conditions given in as below;

1. Only Retired SSE/P.Way having Lien in NCR, NR and NER will be eligible and may be considered for re-engagement against vacancy in the same substantive pay-level held by him/her at the time of retirement. **2.** Headquarter of the Re-Engaged employee will be CRS/NE Cricle/LKO office. **3.** Salary of the Re-engaged employee will be charged from the vacant post from bill unit where post of SSE/P.Way is vacant. **4.** Posting on the notified post will be based on extention of policy period for re-engagement circulated vide Railway Board RBE No.96/2024 dated 15.10.2024. **5.** Medical fitness of the appropriate category should be obtained from the designated authorities as per existing practices. **6.** Retired employees being re-engaged should not have been covered under the Safety Related Retirement Scheme/Liberalized Active Retirement Scheme for Guaranteed Employment for Safety staff (LARSGESS)/Removed/ Dismissed/Compulsory retired. **7.** Suitability/competency of the staff will be adjudged by a committee. **8.** Re-engaged employees should be free from DAR/Vigilance cases. **9.** Re-engagement shall be up to Maximum 65 years. **10.** Remunerations, allowances and leave of re-engaged retired staff will be as per guideline issued by Rly Board & OM No.F.No.3-25/2020-E.IIIA dated 09.12.2020 of Department of Expenditure, Ministry of Finance, Government of India which are as under: **(a)** A fixed monthly amount shall be admissible as remuneration during the contract period, arrived at by deducting the basic pension from the pay drawn at the time of retirement. The amount of remuneration so fixed shall remain unchanged for the term of the contract. **(b)** No increment, Dearness Allowance and HRA shall be allowed during the term of the contract. **(c)** An appropriate and fixed amount as Transport Allowance for the purpose of commuting between the residence and the place of work shall be allowed not exceeding the rate applicable to the appointee at the time of retirement. The amount so fixed shall remain unchanged during the term of appointment. However, they may be allowed TA/DA on official tour, if any, as per their entitlement at the time of retirement. **(d)** Paid leave of absence may be allowed at the rate of 1.5 days for each completed month of service. Accumulation of leave beyond a calendar year will not be allowed. **11.** Engagement period of an individual retired staff will be for a period of 01 year (Subject to extenton of policy period) or till further orders, whichever is earlier. However, based on satisfactory performance of a re-engaged retired staff, his/her period of engagement can further be extended for a further period of one year or till attainment of 65 years of age, whichever is earlier. **12.** Re-engaged staff will be discharged immediately on joining of selected candidates from RRBs. **13.** Re-engaged staff shall not be made in charge of the Unit re-engaged staff shall not be given the financial and D&AR powers and shall not be authorized to issue any safety certificate. Re-engaged staff may recommend their suggestions on financial and other matters to regular or in-service staff/officer. **14.** Only employees of Railways who have retired due to superannuation and is from the same category and same department for which notification is issued are eligible to apply. **15.** The selected applicant can be posted at any station of Construction Organization/NCR. **16.** The re-engaged employees shall execute an agreement to abide by all the terms and conditions of the re-engagement. **17.** The administration is at liberty to terminate the services of the re-engaged employees even before completion of his term in case their work/conduct is found unsatisfactory by giving a notice of 7 days. The re-engaged retired staff should give a notice of 7 days before discontinuing his services.

How to apply

The eligible and willing Railway retired SSE/P.Way should apply on prescribed format (enclosed as Annexure- 'A') and submit the same along with required documents viz. Self-attested (i) photocopy of P.P.O. (ii) Service Certificates (iii) Pension Identity Card and (iv) 02 copies of recent passport size photograph so as to reach to CAO/C Office, Hall No. 02, H-Block, Bhagirathi Building, Subedarganj, North Central Railway, Prayagraj-211015 (UP) **latest by 30 October 2026.**

The notification is also available on NCR's website **http://ncr.Indianrailways.gov.in**.

(Iftikhar Ahmad Khan)
SPO/Const.
For CAO/C/NCR

2246/26 (MG)

North central railways | @CPRONCR | www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

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UJVN LIMITED

H.O.: "UJJWAL", Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephones: 0135-2763808, Fax: 0135-2763508
CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866 Website: www.ujvnl.com

Letter No: 903 **Short Term e-Tender Notice** Date: 01/10/2026

Office of the Executive Engineer, PCM(GV), Mayapur, Haridwar invites sealed & separate tenders from interested bidders. Brief summary of tenders are given below:-

1. Tender Notice Reference:
NIT No.- 17/2026-27/EE/PCM(GV)/Mayapur:-
Restoration work of Tail Race Channel of Pathri Power House.
NIT No.- 18/2026-27/EE/PCM(GV)/Mayapur:-
Forebay Protection work of Mohammadpur Power House.
2. Estimated Value of Tenders:- Rs. 1,49,92,004.63, Rs 77,14,958.26 respectively only, Excluding GST.
3. Date of availability of bid document on website:- 02.10.2026 from 10:00 Hrs.
4. Last date for submission of bids on website:- 16.10.2026 upto 13:00 Hrs.
5. Date of Opening of Tender:- 17.10.2026 upto 11:00 Hrs.
For fuller & further details, kindly visit e-procurement portal **http://uktenders.gov.in**

Executive Engineer, PCM (GV), Mayapur, Haridwar

"AVOID WASTEFUL USE OF ELECTRICITY"

INDIAN RAILWAYS

GOVERNMENT OF INDIA
MINISTRY OF RAILWAYS
(RAILWAY BOARD)

No. RS(POL)58/0506/1/2027 **New Delhi, Dt. 29.09.2026**

Sub: Publication of E-Tender Notice against Ministry of Railways (Railway Board)'s E-Tender No. 2027 AAR AG TC for procurement of AAR Approved Greases for the C.P. 01.01.2027 to 31.12.2027

Director, Railway Stores(M), Ministry of Railways (Railway Board), Government of India, for and on behalf of the President of India invites e-tender as per details given hereunder:-

1.	**E-Tender No.**	**2027 AAR AG TC**
2.	**Name of Work**	Purchase of AAR approved/RDSO approved Grease for Cartridge Taper Roller Bearings of Freight Stock conforming to RDSO specification No. WD-24-Misc.2003 (Revision-1) with Amendment No. 1 of October, 2016.

AAR Approved Brands

Sl.No.	Brand of Grease	Manufacturer
1.	Exxon Arapen RB-320	M/s Exxon Mobil
2.	Timken Premium Rail Grease	M/s Exxon Mobil
3.	Shell Alvania EP-D	M/s Shell Canada Ltd.
4.	Mobilith SHC- 100	M/s Exxon Mobil
5.	Mobilith SHC -221	M/s Exxon Mobil
6.	Shell Gadus Rail S3 AAR AL	Shell Oil Products
7.	Servogrease 'REP 1'	M/s IOC Ltd.

3.	**Approx. quantity in Kilogram**	2,51,561 Kilogram
4.	**Earnest Money**	Rs. 20,00,000 /-
5.	**Last date and time for closing of e-tender**	28.10.2026 at 14.30 hrs.
6.	**Website for complete details of e-tendering and further corrigenda, if any in the tender**	**http://www.ireps.gov.in**
7.	**Allocation Head**	Grant No. 01

Director, Railway Stores (M)
3415/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Tendering Notice

Sr. DEE/TRD/Agra for & on behalf of President of India invites **"Open Tender"** through on-line only **(e-Tendering)** for the following work.

Tender No.: AGCTRDT202619R1	**Approximate Cost:** Rs. 50,37,978/-
Name of work: Modification in OHE due to Construction of 2 Lane ROB No. 157 by increasing Height and Rebuilding of Old ROB at km 83/5-6 between Agra Fort-Idgah Stations.	
Earnest Money: Rs. 1,00,800/-	**Period of completion:** 12 months

1. For full details & submission of the bid please see the Indian Railway website **www.ireps.gov.in. 2.** Tender can only be submitted through web portal **"www.ireps.gov.in"** up to **15.30 Hrs.** on date **23.10.2026.** **2252/26(K)**

North central railways | www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in | @ CPRONCR

UJVN Ltd.

(An Uttarakhand Govt. Enterprises)
H.O. "UJJWAL" Maharani Bagh, GMS Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephone-0135-2763808 Fax: 0135-2763508
CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866 Website: www.ujvnl.com

RO No. 904 **Date: 01.10.2026**

E- Tender Date Extension Notice No-01

Due to unavoidable reasons the dates of e-tender no 01/UJVNL/ EE(CD-III)/ 2026-27 for "Hiring of one number light diesel vehicle (M&M Bolero or equivalent) along with driver on rent basis for 12 months for DGM(CD-II), Dehradun" Uttarakhand are hereby extended as follows:-

Last Date for submission of bid document on website: 16.10.2026 up to 17:00 Hrs.
Last Date for submission of documents in Hard copy: 17.10.2026 up to 16:00 Hrs.
For fuller & further details, kindly visit e-procurement portal **"https://uktenders.gov.in"**

Executive Engineer (CD-III)

"AVOID WASTEFUL USE OF ELECTRICITY"

JAMMU AND KASHMIR POLICE
DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS JAMMU
0191-2561578 (O), 0191-254780 (F),
email-sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in
Hue and Cry Notice
Rule No. 712/191

Dy. SP HQ, Jammu has intimated that accused person namely Mohd Shafi S/O Fakir Din R/O Thilla Ramkot Udhampur, Jammu is evading his arrest/wanted in case FIR No. 172/2001 U/S 279/337/338 RPC, of P/S Nowabad, Jammu, since the commission of crime. Despite repeated raids/efforts the accused could not be traced/still absconded.

It is therefore requested that Hue and Cry Notice of above mentioned accused is being published for the information of Police establishments / Public in general having any clue related to the whereabouts / present location of above named accused, kindly communicate the same on the below mentioned contact / Telephone numbers.

Description Roll :-

Name	:	**Mohd Shafi**
S/O	:	**Fakir Din**
Address	:	**Thilla Ramkot Udhampur, Jammu**

Contacts/Telephone Numbers:-

1.DPO, Jammu	:0191-2547807, 0191-2561578
2. SSP Jammu Mail I.D	: sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in
3.PCR Jammu	:0191-2605949
4.SP City South	: 0191-2433778
5.Dy. SP Hqrs.	: 0191-2562259
6.SHO P/S Nowabad	: 0191-2565274

Sd/-
Sr. Superintendent of Police
Jammu

DIP No:DIP/J-11551/26

OFFICE OF THE SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER
PUBLIC WORKS DEPARTMENT, CIRCLE NO-1 RAIPUR (C.G.)
Tender Notice

Contractors, Registered appropriate class in **Unified Registration system [e- Registration]** invited Online tenders for the following works.

NIT No./ System Tender No.	Name of Work	Probable amount of contract
1	2	3
217/200444	CONSTRUCTION OF RCC ROOF WITH COLUMNS AND FOOTING IN PLACE OF TIN SHED AT OLD BUILDING OF BAR ASSOCIATION IN CIVIL COURT CAMPUS, RAIPUR (C.G.) (1st Call)	Rs. 63.97 Lakh
216/200442	SPECIAL REPAIR WORK AT ATAL EXPRESS WAY, RAIPUR C.G. FOR R.O.W PROTECTION WORK OF UNAUTHOURISED ENTRY/EXIT ON CARRIAGE WAY (1st Call)	Rs. 16.85 Lakh
218/200445	RENOVATION I/C ELECTRIFICATION WORK AT BOYS HOSTEL NO. 01,02,03, IN SCIENCE COLLEGE CAMPUS, RAIPUR (DEPOSIT WORK) (1st Call)	Rs. 149.91 Lakh
173/200538	S/R, MOW, DEPOSIT AND OTHER WORK OF VARIOUS ROADS ARANG & MANDIR HASOUD SECTION UNDER SUB-DIVISION SURVEY RAIPUR (C.G.) (2nd Call)	Rs. 20.50 Lakh
219/200579	AMC OF FIRE FIGHTING & FIRE ALARM SYSTEM OF CG SADAN,CG NIWAS DWARKA,CG BHAWAN,TRIBAL YOUTH HOSTEL DWARKA, AT C.G. BHAWAN DIVISION NEW DELHI (1st Call)	Rs. 60.26 Lakh
220/200580	ANNUAL OPERATION AND MAINTENANCE OF STP SBR PLANT (50 KLD), WTP PLANT AND RO PLANT (2000 LPH) OF CG NIWAS, DWARKA, NEW DELHI (1st Call)	Rs. 14.60 Lakh

NIT No. 217 System Tender No.200444, NIT No. 216 System Tender No.200442 NIT No. 218 System Tender No.200445, NIT No. 219 System Tender No.200579 & NIT No. 220 System Tender No.200580 Last date of tender Download Date up to 19.10.2026 Time 17:30 PM & NIT No. 173 System Tender No.200538 Last date of tender Download Date up to 14.10.2026 Time 17:30 PM

G 262703684/3

QUOTATION NOTICE NO. 2 (2026-27)

Name of Work:- Sealed and subscribed quotation are invited by the Executive Engineer, North Mumbai Division -Andheri, Mumbai for **Supplying items for the New Integrated High Court Complex at Bandra Government Colony, CTS No. 629/1234/A, Bandra (East), Mumbai.** So as to reach this office on or before Date **01/10/2026 To 08/10/2026** Opening Date **09/10/2026** to 15.00 P.M. and will be opened on the same day if possible.

Sr. No.	Description	Qty	Unit	Rate
1	Providing and laying in position premium quality selected granite stone flooring of approved colour, shade, texture and origin, in intricate, elaborate and complex architectural inlay pattern as per approved architectural drawings, detailed design, shop drawings and approved samples, including granite pieces of various colours and shades, of required shapes, sizes and profiles, forming floral, geometric, ornamental, medallion, border, curved and other decorative patterns, including precision cutting, shaping, dressing and fitting of individual granite pieces by CNC/water jet or other approved precision cutting methods, including preparation of detailed templates, computerized/design setting-out, pattern marking, numbering and dry laying/trial assembly of granite pieces prior to final fixing, laid over cement mortar 1:6 bed of required thickness, including all necessary levelling, alignment and matching of adjoining pieces, cement floats, filling of joints with approved colour-matched epoxy grout/approved joint-filling material, wherever specified, curing, machine grinding, multi-stage diamond polishing, honing, edge dressing/bevelling, final polishing, buffing and cleaning of the completed surface, including selected granite wastage and breakage arising out of intricate cutting and pattern formation, cutting and fabrication charges, templates, mock-up/sample panel, skilled specialist workmanship, CNC/water-jet machinery, tools and tackles, handling, stacking, transportation within site and all incidental works complete in all respects as per approved drawings, samples, specifications and directions of the Engineer-in-Charge.	1	sqm	
2	Providing and laying GRANITE stone of 65 mm thick, x-cream with short blasted river wash finish for dry cladding, including filling joints with polymer base filler nosing the sharp edges wherever necessary, etc. complete.	1	sqm	
3	Providing and laying GRANITE stone of 50 mm thick, x-cream with short blasted river wash finish for dry cladding, including filling joints with polymer base filler nosing the sharp edges wherever necessary, etc. complete.	1	sqm	
4	75 mm thick marble artwork/carved panel, of approved quality marble, as per Architect's approved design, including cutting, carving, dressing, polishing and fixing complete.	1	sqm	

Note:-
1. **The rates should be quoted by excluding GST.**
2. **These rates are only for estimate purpose.**
3. **All item-wise details have been published online on the https://mahatenders.gov.in Please refer to these details and quote your rates accordingly.**

The suppliers/ contractors/ firms/ should ensure that their quotation to submitted on or before the expiry of the date and time. This office on account of any cause will be entertained for the late receipt of the tenders / quotations will accept no delay. The rates for the said work are to be quoted by the company having 10 to 15 years of experience otherwise the rates will not be considered. Right to reject any one or all quotation is reserved by the undersigned.

No.EE/NMD/ Tender/ **5832** /2026
Office of the Executive Engineer, North Mumbai (P.W.) Division, Dadabhai Road, Near Bhavan's College, Andheri (West), Mumbai - 400 058. Date:- **28 SEP 2026** **Dgipr/2026-27/3053**

Executive Engineer,
North Mumbai (P.W.) Division,
Andheri (West), Mumbai

Briefs

Nitesh settles for silver in Wrestling

NAGOYA: Nitesh Siwach missed out on a historic gold but secured India's first silver medal in Greco-Roman wrestling at the Asian Games since 1962, while Mansi Ahlawat lost the bronze medal play-off in women's 62kg event here on Thursday.

Nitesh, who had the opportunity to become India's first Greco-Roman gold medallist at the Asian Games in 64 years, went down 0-4 to Japan's home favourite Yuri Nakazato in the men's 97kg final.

Ganesh wins bronze in archery

NAGOYA: Indian compound archer Ganesh Mani Ratnam Thirumuru produced a commanding performance to win the men's individual bronze medal at the Asian Games here on Thursday. Ganesh, who was a part of the gold-winning men's team on Wednesday, defeated Vietnam's Cong Duc Dang 149-144 in the bronze medal play-off after bowing out of individual gold contention with a semifinal loss.

ASIAN GAMES: TEAM WILL FACE MALAYSIA IN TITLE CLASH

India survive Pak scare to enter final after Abhishek's late strike

Pakistan's goals were scored by Abu Mahmood, Hannan and Waheed

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Kakamigahara, October 1

Defending champions India survived a scare before Abhishek struck with just 45 seconds remaining to snatch a dramatic 4-3 victory over arch-rivals Pakistan and seal a place in the Asian Games hockey final here on Thursday.

Harmanpreet converted two perfectly executed penalty corners in the 5th and 13th minutes, while Sukhjeet Singh scored a field goal in the 23rd minute. Abhishek scored the winning goal for India from a field play in the final minute of the game.

Pakistan's goals were scored by Abu Mahmood (30th minute), Hannan Shahid (45th) and Waheed Rana (49th).

The defending champions looked set for a comfortable semifinal win after captain Harmanpreet's brace and Sukhjeet Singh's field strike put them firmly in control.

But a stunning second-half collapse allowed Pakistan to claw their way back as they scored three goals and push India to the brink of an embarrassing defeat before Abhishek's late strike rescued the contest.



Abhishek, Mandeep Singh, Sukhjeet Singh, Sumit, Manpreet Singh and Rajinder Singh celebrate after winning the men's semifinal hockey match between against Pakistan in Kakamigahara on Thursday PTI

HIGHLIGHTS

- The defending champions looked set for a comfortable semi-final win after captain Harmanpreet's brace and Sukhjeet Singh's field strike put them firmly in control
- India, who had dominated the opening half, inexplicably retreated into their shell after the break

India, who had dominated the opening half, inexplicably retreated into their shell after the break, surrendering control of the midfield and allowing Pakistan's young forwards to dictate the pace and flow of the game.

With their defence under sustained pressure and their attacking threat blunted, the Indians were left scrambling to protect their lead.

Just as the contest appeared headed for a shootout, Abhishek found the decisive touch, with his effort taking a deflection off Pakistan defender Sufiyan and beating goalkeeper Ali Raza to send India into the final, where they will meet the winner of the other semifinal between South Korea and Malaysia.

The late winner spared India the consequences of a remarkable capitulation, but their inability to close out a match they had dominated for long stretches will raise questions ahead of the title clash.

India began aggressively, pinning Pakistan deep in their own half and winning a series of penalty corners.

After four unsuccessful attempts, Harmanpreet finally broke through with a powerful drag-flick in the fifth minute, sending the ball between Ali Raza's legs to give India the lead.

The Indian skipper doubled the advantage in the 13th minute, drilling home another penalty corner after a purposeful run down the left by Manpreet Singh had earned India their seventh set-piece opportunity.

Pakistan offered little resistance for much of the first quarter, struggling to cope with India's attacking combinations and repeatedly conceding territory.

Sukhjeet made it 3-0 in the 23rd minute, tapping home after Shilanand Lakra delivered a pinpoint pass from left of the goalline.

Kishan's unbeaten 80 on tough pitch sends India to Asiad final

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Nisshin, October 1

Ishan Kishan's calculated 46-ball 80 on a difficult track laid the foundation as India hammered Sri Lanka by 124 runs in the Asian Games men's cricket semifinal here on Thursday to set up a gold medal clash with arch-foes Pakistan. Kishan and Vaibhav Sooryavanshi (38 off 21) took India to 169 for seven on a turning track after Sri Lanka put India in to bat.

While chasing the 170-run target, the island nation first collapsed to 31 for six inside the powerplay before being eventually bundled out for 45.

Jasprit Bumrah struck twice in his opening over and was then joined by Axar Patel, who also claimed two wickets.

Sri Lanka's collapse included two run-outs, which was ample proof of them being rattled by the pitch and the loss of early wickets. The odd ball was flying off the surface, sowing doubts in the batters' minds. In the end, India took just 9.5 overs to dismiss them. The Lankans will now fight for bronze in the play-off against Bangladesh, who were beaten by Pakistan earlier in the day.

Both the bronze medal and the final will be held here on Saturday.







FATIMA ON PRIYANKA'S PRAISE FOR HER 'HUNKKAAR' PERFORMANCE

'Her liking my performance was a huge validation'

The show has resonated with audiences and received a positive response

OUR CORRESPONDENT

Fatima Sana Shaikh, a prominent actress, recently appeared in 'Hunkkaar: The Roar'. The show has resonated with audiences and received a positive response in its release week. Shaikh recently sat down with 'IMDb' for their exclusive segment 'Behind The Scenes', wherein she spoke about stepping into the world of law enforcement, the chaos of shooting in freezing conditions and what it meant to hear Priyanka Chopra praise her performance.

Describing the show, Shaikh said, "'Hunkkaar' is a very gritty thriller. It's a story about four underdogs fighting a big force for justice, almost like David versus Goliath and which proves that justice shall prevail."

Asked about Priyanka Chopra's public appreciation of her work, Shaikh was visibly delighted. "I was so happy and I was so excited because I'm a huge fan of hers. So, for me, her liking my performance was a huge validation," she said, before adding, "I love you, Priyanka."

'HUNKKAAR IS A VERY GRITTY THRILLER. IT'S A STORY ABOUT FOUR UNDERDOGS FIGHTING A BIG FORCE FOR JUSTICE,' SAYS FATIMA SANA SHAIKH



Fatima revealed she was hooked on the project from the start. "I read the script within a day, actually. They gave me five episodes and I was like, 'Please dedo, please dedo'," she recalled. She also shared that she felt her character had further potential and collaborated with the creators to develop it. "They were open to having conversations and they were open to my suggestions. So, we dug a little deeper; I also presented some ideas and we collaborated on it," she said.

To prepare for her role, the actress met police officers across different ranks. The experience changed how she sees the force. "We often paint the system in one colour and we think that they are against us, but a system is made of individuals. There are a lot of officers who really want to protect us. Especially now, after playing the character, we must celebrate them because they really work very hard for us," she said.

Shaikh also opened up about the toughest day on set, a freezing night shoot in uniform. "It was so cold and I was wearing this uniform. My teeth were chattering and it was around 3 or 4 am. Even the focus puller couldn't operate properly; even the mashaal went off and I couldn't complete my dialogues," she recalled.

Speaking about her co-stars, Shaikh said she was in awe of Mohd. Zeeshan Ayyub and Raghubir Yadav. "Zeeshan is very fluid. He's extremely light in his performances; he's instinctively good and puts so many layers to such a complex character." On Raghu ji, she said, "As a person, he's such a soft person. He's such a cutie. What a pookie," adding that he plays a character whose morality is completely opposite to his own.

On the power of storytelling, Shaikh said cinema can shift perspectives in ways conversation cannot. "It isn't about me telling you that feminism is right but firsthand seeing how that character is actually living through and fighting those battles. That connects a little more deeply than just a random conversation."

She named 'Dangal' as a film that left a strong impact on her, drawing a parallel to 'Hunkkaar'.

'Stree 3 to release in 2028'

Producer Dinesh Vijan said Amar Kaushik has finished writing the film



'AMAR KAUSHIK IS THE MOST INTEGRAL PART OF THE 'STREE',' SAYS VIJAN

Producer Dinesh Vijan announced that director Amar Kaushik has already completed the script for 'Stree 3' and the third part of the film will be released in 2028.

'Stree', which was released in 2018 and became an instant hit, kickstarted Vijan's horror-comedy universe, which features films such as 'Roohi', 'Bhediya', 'Munjya', 'Stree 2' and 'Thamma'.

Before starting work on 'Stree 3', Kaushik will direct the upcoming mythological drama 'Mahavatar', a film based on the story of Bhagwan Parshuram. It stars Vicky Kaushal in the lead.

"Amar Kaushik is the most integral part of the 'Stree' and horror-comedy franchise," Vijan said. PTI

There's an added responsibility as an artist now: Yami



Winning the National Film Award has been a 'true validation' and comes with an added responsibility to make better and more diverse choices, said Yami Gautam. The actress, who won the award for 'Best Actress' for her role in 'Article 370' last month, is playing a mysterious new bride with superpowers in the upcoming horror-comedy 'Nayyi Navelli'.

"The National Film Award is a really big honour. I think it's a very true validation for any artist across all languages, all formats that you can receive in our country and I take it with all humility. I'd be lying if I said, no, nothing's changed. There's an added responsibility in me as an artist," Gautam told reporters at the trailer launch of the film. PTI

CELEBRATION AT NORWEGIAN SEAFOOD DINNER

Norway & India mark one year of trade partnership

The evening brought together 150 guests from across the seafood value chain

OUR CORRESPONDENT

The Royal Norwegian Embassy and the Norwegian Seafood Council (NSC) hosted a Norwegian seafood dinner at the Embassy on September 30 to mark the first anniversary of the India-EFTA Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement (TEPA) entering into force. The evening brought together 150 guests from across the seafood value chain, including importers, distributors, retailers, hoteliers, chefs, government representatives and media for a conversation on how the market for Norwegian salmon and seafood can grow in India. Before the dinner, 'The Norwegian Seafood Seminar 2026' was organised to share information about Norwegian seafood, the potential for future cooperation and to provide the possibility to meet Norwegian export companies.

TEPA marked its first anniversary of entering into force on October 1, 2026. The dinner offered a platform for dialogue on market development, trade and future opportunities for Norwegian seafood and highlighted how closer economic cooperation can support long-term growth, innovation and consumer access to premium seafood products.

"One year on, the India-EFTA Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement is delivering tangible results for Norwegian seafood in India. Norway and India share an interest in trade that is open, sustainable and built on long-term partnerships and this evening was a chance to celebrate what has been achieved and to look at what comes next," said May-Elin Stener, Norway's Ambassador to India.



Norway's Ambassador to India, May-Elin Stener, with guests at Norwegian Seafood Dinner



Chef Saby creating dishes using Norwegian seafood at Norwegian Seafood Dinner



Norwegian Seafood Dinner

Celebrity Chef Sabyasachi Gorai built the menu around Norwegian seafood and the star was salmon served two ways: Jerk-spiced Salmon, Pan-fried with Hot Honey and BBQ-rubbed Salmon with Paprika Cream. Grilled Scallop on the Half Shell and Lemon Herb Cod with Garlic Crumble and Creamy Garlic Velouté were other Norwegian Seafood attractions, with all the mains served on a bed of Spanish paella. The hors d'oeuvres included King Crab Salad with Avocado and Cold Water Shrimp Cocktail.

TEPA MARKED ITS FIRST ANNIVERSARY OF ENTERING INTO FORCE ON OCTOBER 1, 2026

"Demand that lasts is never built by a single link in the chain. It's built when importers, retailers, chefs and partners sit at the same table. Tonight showed how much appetite India has for Norwegian salmon and our job now is to ensure that appetite is matched by understanding of where the fish comes from, how it is farmed and why it can be trusted," said Johan Kvalheim, Industry Manager at the Norwegian Seafood Council.

The dinner came on the back of a strong start to the year, with Norwegian salmon exports to India up 141 per cent to 361 tonnes and value up 143 per cent to NOK 26.2 million (Rs 264.75 million) between January and August 2026. Tariffs on the remaining salmon categories continue to fall under TEPA and are expected to reach zero by 2029.

विद्युत मंत्रालय
MINISTRY OF POWER
सत्यमेव जयते



"India has adopted unique and innovative energy conservation methods, which are furthering sustainable development and also benefitting citizens."
Narendra Modi
Prime Minister



National Painting Competition
On Energy Conservation–2026

THEMES
Save Energy at School and Home
Energy Conservation is the Key for Energy Security

Group A
5th, 6th & 7th Standard

Group B
8th, 9th & 10th Standard

Prizes Worth Painting For

Prize Category	State/UT Level Prize			Prize Category	National Level Prize		
	No of Prize	Group A	Group B		No of Prize	Group A	Group B
First Prize/ Gold Medal	01 No	₹ 50,000/-	₹ 50,000/-	First Prize/ Gold Medal	01 No	₹ 1,00,000/-	₹ 1,00,000/-
Second Prize/ Silver Medal	01 No	₹ 30,000/-	₹ 30,000/-	Second Prize/ Silver Medal	01 No	₹ 50,000/-	₹ 50,000/-
Third Prize/ Bronze Medal	01 No	₹ 20,000/-	₹ 20,000/-	Third Prize/ Bronze Medal	01 No	₹ 30,000/-	₹ 30,000/-
Appreciation Prize	10 Nos	₹ 7,500/-	₹ 7,500/-	Appreciation Prize	10 Nos	₹ 15,000/-	₹ 15,000/-

National winners will also receive laptops/tablets and an opportunity for a study tour in India

LAST DATE FOR SUBMISSION OF PAINTINGS: 15th OCTOBER 2026

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